
FINAL REPORT

**Eighteenth
Annual Meeting
of the
General Service
Conference
of
Alcoholics Anonymous**

**Roosevelt Hotel
New York
April 22-27, 1968**



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An A.A. member may order a copy of this report through his G.S.R. or other Group Officer. Traditionally, all members have the right of access to information about all phases of A.A.'s General Services. This report is "confidential" only because in it certain members must be identified by name. The "confidential" designation protects the personal anonymity of such members at the public level.

\$1 50 per copy



"....personal recovery depends upon A.A. unity."

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Eighteenth Annual Meeting

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Unfortunately room does not permit inclusion of all the Ask-It Basket Question and Answers. We have tried to include those of most general interest.

Excerpts from

THE CONFERENCE CHARTER

1. *Purpose:* The General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous is the guardian of the world services and of the Twelve Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous. The Conference shall be a service body only; never a government for Alcoholics Anonymous.

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2. *Composition:* The Conference (North American Section) shall be composed of State and Provincial Delegates, the Trustees of the General Service Board, Directors, the surviving co-founder of A.A., and Staff Members of Headquarters or foreign Delegates as the Conference may wish to invite.

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3. *Conference Relation to A.A.:* The Conference will act for A.A. in the perpetuation and guidance of its world services, and it will also be the vehicle by which the A.A. movement can express its views upon all matters of vital A.A. policy and all hazardous deviations from A.A. Tradition. Delegates should be free to vote as their conscience dictates; they should also be free to decide what questions should be taken to the group level, whether for information, discussion or their own direct instruction.

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4. *Conference Relation to A.A. Headquarters:* The Conference will replace the founders of Alcoholics Anonymous who formerly functioned as guides and advisers to The General Service Board and its related Headquarters services. The Conference will be expected to afford a reliable cross section of A.A. opinion for this purpose.

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Unity Vital To A.A. Survival, Growth

18th A.A. Conference Reviews New Concepts

New concepts, new approaches and new techniques of service are being explored so that A.A. can find better ways of reaching the alcoholic who still suffers, Dr. John L. Norris, Chairman of the General Service Board, told Delegates to the Eighteenth General Service Conference.

Pointing out that these new concepts of service did not mean changes in the A.A. way of life, program or Traditions, Dr. Norris said that there is a "ferment" today in the whole world of alcoholism and that in the immediate future A.A. will face a continuing series of challenges and opportunities.

As example of new approaches made by A.A.'s General Service Board, Dr. Norris noted plans to participate in professional meetings such as the 28th International Congress on Alcohol and Alcoholism to be held this September at Washington, D.C. Gathering there to discuss the problem of alcoholism will be doctors, sociologists, educators and public health experts from all over the world — many of whom know nothing about A.A., he said.

Another new concept cited by Dr. Norris, and later unanimously approved by Delegates, was that of a World Service Meeting at which delegates from a dozen countries and areas will work to solve problems of mutual concern and share experience on a worldwide basis.

Dr. Norris also commented on plans to take advantage of the challenge offered by the expected decision of the United States Supreme Court that alcoholics are sick people and that a man cannot be arrested simply because he is drunk.

"Personal recovery depends upon A.A. unity" was the theme of the Conference, guiding Delegates in their presentations, discussion and debate on the present and future course of A.A. affairs.

Speaking to Delegates on the opening day of the Conference, Bill W., surviving co-founder of A.A., said that without unity there is no recovery, and noted that all Traditions related to unity and our common welfare.

Delegates Discuss A.A. Affairs

New York, April 27 — Delegates representing A.A. members from throughout the United States and Canada had reviewed virtually all aspects of current A.A. affairs by the conclusion here today of the 18th General Service Conference.

Acting to meet the challenge of the future, Delegates at the Roosevelt Hotel conferred for five and one-half days. In so doing, they sought more effective means of holding out the hand of A.A. to the world's still suffering alcoholics and to provide guidance to the General Service Office in its efforts to improve assistance to the groups.

Eighty-nine Delegates, elected by groups from every state and province, together with alcoholic and nonalcoholic Trustees from the General Service Board, G.S.O. and Grapevine Directors and Staff Members form the 135-member Conference. Their actions on behalf of the Fellowship guide the activities and policies of the Board, G.S.O. and Grapevine. Some Conference highlights:

ANONYMITY — Delegates reaffirmed the principle of anonymity at the public level. Noted that full face appearance on TV, press and films is an anonymity break even though name is withheld.

INTERNATIONAL — Delegates voted to participate in first World Service Meeting, set for New York in 1969. Delegates from dozen countries to attend.

PUBLIC INFORMATION — Approved proposal to conduct survey among A.A. members, reviewed plans to increase effort among hard-to-reach alcoholics.

INSTITUTIONS — Recommended that local institutions committees improve communications with G.S.O. by sending in detailed reports of activities for sharing with the Fellowship.

GRAPEVINE — Recommended adoption of GV Group Sponsorship Program, encouraging groups to send new subscriptions to local professional people, agencies and institutions as a joint Twelfth-Step activity.

FINANCES — Reported group contributions still lag behind service costs, but that regular contribution plan is growing slowly but surely in most areas.

LITERATURE — Suggested that a yearly questionnaire be sent to a sampling of A.A. groups to determine literature needs.

G.S. BOARD — Elected Don F. as regional Trustee candidate from the West Central Region.

WORLD DIRECTORY — Delegates approved proposition to issue directory in two parts — one for U.S. and Canada, the second for other countries.

1970 CONVENTION — Preparations underway, facilities chosen for 35th Annual Convention, Miami Beach, July 3-5, 1970.

NEW CONFERENCE AREA — Approved third bilingual Delegate from Province of Quebec. This Delegate to be elected to Panel 19 from the new Conference Area, Northeast Quebec.

NEW A.A. SIZE

Based on Reports to G.S.O., Spring 1968

	Groups	Members
United States . . .	8,484	142,566
Canada	1,411	18,757
Overseas	2,784	54,744
In Hospitals . . .	645	16,307
In Prisons	830	29,870
Internationalists .	—	318
Lone Members . .	—	464
Totals	14,154	263,026

(including "non-reported" members, actual membership is estimated at more than 400,000.)

Digest of Agenda

MONDAY, APRIL 22

Registration and Tour of G.S.O. and GV.
Welcome Session and Keynote — A.A. Unity.
• Staff Reports, Review of Agenda, Committees.
Opening Dinner: Regular A.A. Meeting.

TUESDAY, APRIL 23

Joint Meetings of Trustees and Conference Committees.
Conference Committee Meetings.
General Service Board Report.
Policy Committee Report.
Film: "A Time for Decision."
A.A.W.S. Report.
1970 Convention Report.
Presentation: "Group Harmony: How We Maintain It."
"Area Delegates Only" Dinner and Meeting.

WEDNESDAY, APRIL 24

Presentation: "A New Concept in World Harmony."
Regional Trustee Election.
Presentation: "Is Anonymity Slipping at the Public Level?"
Interview Time.
Conference Committee Meetings.

THURSDAY, APRIL 25

Presentation: Grapevine.
Public Information.
Getting to "Hard to Reach" Alcoholics.

A REGULAR A.A. MEETING

The A.A. meeting was led by Rollie D., Trustee from Eastern Canada, who "landed in the gutter with no hat on." Although he tried many times to stop, he was never successful. "When I reached the end of the road, I had to make a decision. I had lost everything. My wife had committed suicide, my son was in jail and I had no home or anything else. I was led to A.A. where I received counsel and guidance. Today, after some eighteen years of sobriety, I am happier than I have ever been in my life."

May C., Delegate from Eastern Massachusetts, described herself as a prude who looked down on those who used alcohol, "until I tried it myself." Her husband laughed the first time she got drunk, but that was the last time he ever laughed about her drinking. "I stopped for a year," she said, "Then when I started again I was convinced that I couldn't be an alcoholic because I had been sober for so long."

May told of drinking more and more, "until I became sick and shaking, almost crazy with despair, hoping that I would die because my children would be better off without me. Finally, I asked for God's help. A quietness came over me and I knew that I would be all right. The next day my sister called and took me to an A.A. meeting. I saw the people and wanted sobriety. I followed every suggestion and today the desire to drink has completely left me."

Ralph B., Delegate from the State of Washington, described himself as a victim of Murphy's law — "If something can go wrong, it most surely will." His drinking started in the Navy and became progressively worse, leading from minor problems to more serious ones, such as aiding and abetting a general court martial prisoner to escape. He described passing out in his fu-

ture father-in-law's kitchen dropping out of school and was being picked up on drunk-driving charges. "My boss heard an A.A. member speak, and asked him to call on me, which he did," Ralph said. "I had totally terminated my relationship with God, and it was not until I was sober in A.A. for five or six years that I became aware of the things I should be grateful for, such as the fact that my children never saw me in action."

DELEGATES WELCOMED TO CONFERENCE

As your Delegate Chairman, it is my pleasure and privilege to welcome you to the 18th General Service Conference. This Conference will be an experience that all of us will remember for the remainder of our lives.

As the Conference began last year, I felt that I should listen and maybe I would hear something to take back home with me. My feeling was that among all of the Delegates, Trustees, and Staff Members present and the presence of Bill, that I had very little to contribute.

After one or two days and being somewhat uneasy, I took an inventory as to why I was here; after all, my state did not send me to New York for the plane ride and a week of relaxation. I realized after much thought that the members of A.A. in North Carolina elected me as their Delegate to serve the best interests of Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole.

I urge you to become a part of the Conference now, for we are here to serve, not to govern. By being a part of the General Service Conference, we are the guardian of world services and the Twelve Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous.

The theme of last year's Conference was "Sponsorship: The Hand of A.A." and the theme this year is "... personal recovery depends upon A.A. unity." These two themes have played a large role in the sobriety that we have been granted.

Some of us may say that we are here today by coincidence. In my time in A.A. I have come to believe that a coincidence is an act of God in the midst of time. Therefore I say to you, we are all here today by an act of God — God, the Father of all mankind.

May the God of your understanding and the God of my understanding be with each of us throughout this Conference.

—Dave C., North Carolina, Chairman,
Delegates only meeting.

VOTE OF CONFIDENCE FOR BOB H.

Be it hereby resolved that the Delegates of both Panel 17 and 18 here present place on the record of this Conference, a vote of confidence in our new General Manager, Bob H., and pledge our fullest cooperation and support to him.

Conference Vital Factor for Unity and Survival

Unity

Keynote

In our Fellowship of A.A., unity, survival and tomorrow are one and the same thing. All of us are well aware if there is not unity, A.A. will not survive. And

without A.A. you and I would not have too many tomorrows. The words unity and survival go together in our lives, the same as sobriety and A.A.

As the General Service Conference continues to grow in effectiveness, it will continue to be a vital factor for unity in A.A. Those who saw the need for the Conference, and brought it to reality, have provided A.A. with one of the greatest vehicles for understanding, communications, and hence unity, that we shall ever have.

Our second Legacy of Unity did not just come off the top of somebody's head. It was as Bill has described "hammered out on the anvil of experience." Much of this experience was of a tragic nature. Many of our early people rode off in all directions, like Don Quixote, in hot pursuit of alcoholic souls. Many were motivated by a very sincere desire to help the still suffering alcoholic, but many were on an exercise of self-glorification, and met with tragedy. Anonymity was thrown to the winds, money was solicited, and in some cases 12th Step work became virtually professionalized. It was most apparent that some guidelines would have to be evolved quickly if we were not to fly apart at the seams.

Early Members Knew

Our early members were also aware of the reasons that the other organizations, who had come before A.A. in the drunk business, had met with disaster. Therefore the lessons learned from our tragic experiences at the time, plus the lessons learned from the demise of the other organizations, were incorporated in the principles of our second Legacy of Unity, in the form of the Twelve Traditions.

It is said that A.A. has Come of Age, and I believe it. In our ability to manage our own affairs at the level of the Conference and the Board, etc., we have progressed. In our relations with other people in the alcoholism business and the community as a whole we have made progress. In our ability to survive criticism without getting into public controversy, we have come a long way. Mind you, we still lose the odd member when some nonalcoholic has the audacity to suggest we are not perfect and know all the answers, but on the whole we have made progress.

Moving into New Era

There are those among us who think and say that now we have come of age, we are on a downhill haul. We have all passed the turning point and all will be "coming up roses" from here on in. I don't believe it. I believe that A.A. is moving into a new era, and that we will be beset with as many dilemmas as before. The total picture of alcoholism has changed drastically over the last 30 years. A.A. has moved in many areas from a "leper colony" status, to being an accepted and respected part of the community. This fact does not remove from us the necessity to adhere to our original principles of unity, but rather increases the need to adhere to them.

More and more we are going to hear the theme, and many times from our friends who have walked with us for many years: "Don't you think that you people could relax your anonymity Tradition," or "why don't you people get out into the open now and really get into the alcoholism business." They are going to say that after 30 years we should start to abandon our old cloak and dagger traditions and get with it. These people will be sincere in their
(to p. 36)

1970 CONVENTION SET FOR MIAMI BEACH

Report

A.A.'s 35th Anniversary International Convention will be held in Miami Beach, Florida, July 3 through July 5, 1970.

During the first week in March, the three coordinators, Dennis Manders, Kleina Jones, and Hazel R. and I visited Miami in order to inspect the facilities and discuss arrangements with the Convention Bureau and hotels. We found all concerned most cooperative and the facilities more than adequate. The Fountainebleau Hotel will be A.A. Convention Headquarters. Registration and daytime meetings will be held there. Convention Hall (two miles from the Fountainebleau) will be the scene of the large evening and Sunday morning meetings and the Big Show on Sunday evening. Bus service will be provided for these meetings.

Registrations and Housing will open in the fall of 1969. Both of these will be handled by G.S.O., and the housing forms will then be forwarded by G.S.O. to the Miami Beach Convention Bureau. Housing will only be confirmed if accompanied by a registration form forwarded from G.S.O. The Convention Committee and the G.S.B. feel the Registration Fee should be \$6.00 and the Host Committee Opening Dance and Closing Show \$4.00. This is a change from the \$5.00 and \$3.00 fees in Toronto.

Bill and Lois plan to be in Miami Beach. Correspondence indicated many others do, too. So, please make your plans and encourage others to share in this heartwarming get-together. These Conventions give each of us an inspiration beyond expression and each A.A.'s presence makes it possible — the A.A. way.

—Bob H., Chairman, A.A.W.S.

'DELEGATES ONLY' MEETING

Conference Action

Two items came up for discussion at the "Area Delegates Only" Meeting at the 18th General Service Conference.

1. It was the sense of the meeting that the meeting be held on Wednesday night, beginning with the 19th General Service Conference.
2. Tom G., Manitoba, was elected as the new Delegate Chairman for the 19th General Service Conference.

—Dave C., North Carolina
Area Delegates Chairman

UNITY: STATE OF 'ONENESS'

Digest of Agenda

MONDAY, APRIL 22

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Welcome Session and Keynote — A.A. Unity.
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Opening Dinner: Regular A.A. Meeting.

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Presentation: "A New Concept in World Harmony."
Regional Trustee Election.
Presentation: "Is Anonymity Slipping at the Public Level?"
Interview Time.
Conference Committee Meetings.

THURSDAY, APRIL 25

Presentation: Grapevine.
Public Information.
Getting to "Hard to Reach" Alcoholics.
Review Regional Trustee Electoral Procedures.
Presentation: "Keeping A.A. Peace in the Community."
Nominating Committee Report.
International Committee Report.
Presentation: World Directory.
Presentation: "Area Problems."
Workshops and Sharing Sessions.

FRIDAY, APRIL 26

Conference Committee Reports, Discussion, Action.
Board Finance Report.
Membership Survey.
Presentation: "How Literature Helps Preserve Unity."
Presentation: "Strengthening the Group."
Filmstrip.
Summary.

SATURDAY, APRIL 27

Closing Brunch.

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"AREA HIGHLIGHTS": Each day time was set aside to hear area Delegates of Panel 18 report on A.A. in their territories. Excerpts from these are carried on pages 15-17

"ASK-IT BASKET": Questions submitted anonymously from the floor were discussed and answered at various times. Summaries of these are found in appropriate places in this Report.

"INTERVIEW TIME": Seven specific questions were put to Delegates in seven separate sections. Summaries of their answers and suggestions are reported in appropriate places in this Report.

This has been a tremendously exciting and rewarding experience. Besides the specific actions you have taken and the guidance you have given us, we all here this week have learned much.

I thought I knew what unity meant. But you have given it fresh meaning for me. Let me then share with you now some of the things you have taught me this past week about unity.

First it was pointed out that unity is the state of "oneness." And what better definition could we have — we, who have but one primary purpose.

One of the things which impressed me most during this past wonderful week was the way certain themes like threads of wisdom ran throughout the many talks we heard.

Consider communications, for example. We were told that communication is a great contributing factor to unity, of how vital to unity good communications are, for not only do good communications strengthen unity, unity also fosters better communications.

Another common theme in many of the talks was "participation," for it is required that we all work together for the good of A.A. as a whole. Whatever we do to get people together in a common activity will enhance unity.

Strength in Unity of Purpose

Responsibility was another of the themes which recurred throughout the week. We heard of our responsibility to insure that A.A. continue to function as a whole. For with us there is strength in unity of purpose. We heard, too, that responsibility is a two-way street. Not only does a group have a responsibility to its Area Committee and Central Office, but these organizations have a responsibility to the group. We were also reminded that as A.A. grows, so does our responsibility, that personal unity is immeasurably strengthened through service, and that we cannot grow without unity.

Looking at special groups of alcoholics, we learned, for instance, that the generation gap can be bridged through our unity of purpose, that oldtimers can be kept active and interested, that professional or well-known people can be attracted to the Fellowship — especially when treated the same as any other drunk.

In discussing anonymity, we stated that unanimous acceptance of this Tradition makes our unity possible. However, we sometimes forget that anonymity at the public and personal levels are two different things. By wrapping the cloak of anonymity around them at a personal level, many A.A. members act as if alcoholism was a disgrace instead of a disease.

Throughout the week we were reminded repeatedly of the spiritual basis of our program. This Conference was described as being illuminated by the grace of God, with Delegates present not to promote the special interests of their areas, but rather to serve the best interests of A.A. as a whole.

I feel that the value of this Conference can finally be judged only by what we give, not by what we have received. By how well, in other words, we all carry out our responsibilities during the next twelve months. Let us, then, carry them out in a spirit of true dedication — gratefully and with humility, unity and love.

—Bob H., Chairman, A.A.W.S.

New Formats Strengthen Groups

Unity

Presentation

We must constantly but cautiously be prepared to change our techniques and our formats in order to strengthen our groups to make them and keep them more attractive to those yet to follow us. Perhaps it is the little things, such as the atmosphere of the meeting place or presenting the same types of speakers. But the little things are the stuff that life is made of. Doing little things for a great purpose makes them great things, and our purpose involves one of life or death.

Every objection of the newcomer that we can meet is one hurdle that we remove from his or her own recovery. We can try different types of meetings, but probably the simplest single thing we can do to infuse unity, strength, an informed group conscience and attractiveness in our groups, would be to have as many members as possible read the pamphlet, "The A.A. Group," and to have the group take the group inventory that it contains.

—Ernie R., Washington, D.C.

KEEPING OLDTIMERS ACTIVE

The question that has bothered us all for some time is, "How do we keep the old member active?" We are trying to get more participation by recognizing oldtimers in our area conference. The first night is dedicated to them and we all enjoy it. They give us the history of A.A. in our area, the trial and errors of early A.A. This has proven to be very beneficial to both the new and old. The badge they wear is titled "Bleeding Deacon" and worn proudly.

Second, how do we attract doctors, ministers, lawyers and public servants to A.A.? Our personal resentment toward the professional man is sometimes readily felt, and they are not encouraged by this feeling. It seems to leave them with that same feeling — they don't belong here, either.

There is the question of anonymity — the name dropping done by members outside our groups or gatherings. We are all equally guilty of this. We feel just a little superior because some professional men in our groups haven't been able to handle their problem through theology, psychology, biology or sociology. Still we should not have that know-it-all grin on our faces. We should have the same compassion for them as we do the gutter drunk, of course. I know of no better way than to treat these guys the same as any other drunk. Give them basic A.A. and tell them how to find out who they are and how we stay sober.

—Ralph M., Southeast Texas.

MORE YOUNG PEOPLE IN A.A.

Today we are seeing more and more young people coming to A.A., because more and more people are becoming knowledgeable about alcoholism, aware that it's treatable and beatable, and that A.A. is necessary for long-range recovery. It's great to see the young person come to A.A. because his pain is real. His need is now. His inability to be responsible is the root of his illness. We must help him to find a climate where he is able to respond.

Beginners have the greatest opportunity for success if they get all the facts presented well and in a manner that is concise and complete. The group should keep uppermost in mind the im-

portance of the newcomer, what his feelings are, what his immediate needs are. He is in trouble.

It is the group's responsibility to convince him he can have a full life, though sober — that he doesn't have to go the full route.

It is the group's responsibility to make meetings attractive to newcomers of all ages. Make them acquainted with the story of A.A. — its start and its growth. Help them to be comfortable in the knowledge that they are suffering from an illness and not mental disease conducive to moral degeneration. Help the young person to fully understand the progression of alcoholism by exchange of ideas from old and young alike, helping to make him aware of the fact that just because he has a ticket on the bus, doesn't mean he has to ride to the end of the line.

Our Eleventh Tradition guides us by suggesting a program of attraction and not promotion. The Tradition is geared toward anonymity, but the word attraction comes on mighty strong. So, let's make our meetings interesting and attractive to the new person, and especially to the young new person. We need them, for they are our strength and our growth.

—Robert W., Southern Wisconsin.

DIFFERENT TYPES OF MEETINGS

Regular open meetings are the most important and necessary meetings. Most alcoholics are a bit doubtful and timid about attending their first meeting. If they can have their spouse, a member of the family, or someone close accompany them, it helps their morale and bolsters their courage. The new member is learning a new way of life and the nonalcoholic will learn, too.

Open discussion meetings are very good because everyone present can take part. Sometimes the discussions are quite lively. A good chairman will keep the meeting under control. When a member has a problem he would like to discuss with the group, he gets a lot of answers and most times a solution. We feel free to discuss our problems at this meeting because everyone is interested and willing to help.

Some members feel more secure at a closed meeting. Everybody present has the same problem and is there for the same reason — to do something about it. He is more inclined to talk with all alcoholics, and doesn't feel he may shock or embarrass anyone. The alcoholic will talk more about himself or herself if the spouse is not present. The anonymity of the members is protected at this type of meeting.

Beginners meetings are good because we sometimes forget what it feels like to be new and unfamiliar with the program. This can be the means of helping a new member to get a good start in the new way of life and prepare him for regular A.A. meetings.

Men— or women—only meetings are the only kind of meeting some men or women will attend. They want no one of the opposite sex around when they talk about their problems. This is fine if there are other A.A. meetings to attend in the area. Talking is easier and freer at this type of meeting.

—Rose B., Western Pennsylvania.

Harmony Maintained Through Group Conscience

Presentation

Groups in Kansas City have come up with an idea that would serve all the members, by breaking down the area into zones. We have four zones and each zone has ten units. These units consist of from four to about fifteen or eighteen members, who meet every Tuesday night in the different homes of members for discussions. Every third Monday we have a meeting, where all problems existing in the units are discussed.

Results are presented to our Rotating Committee. Again, the problems and results are viewed by our Rotating Committee and voted on by the members representing the group.

Then, again, as a situation arises and is brought to the Rotating Committee and voted on, it, in turn, will be presented to the membership of the group through the zone and unit leaders' meetings, and the members as a whole are informed through the zone and unit leaders. There again, the pulse of the group conscience is sensed, the feelings of the membership as a whole have been reached, and the results returned to the Rotating Committee.

—Verne S., Western Missouri.

SELF-SUPPORT NECESSARY

In Orlando, we had a large china pig sitting on the chairman's desk, and after the Lord's Prayer, one member always yelled "Don't forget the pig," and we went up and dropped in our donation. We went to the coffee bar, dropped a coin in the coffee kitty, and talked A.A. We paid rent, light, water, and telephone bills, painted and re-decorated from time to time. It ran par for the course — occasionally a surplus, but more often a deficit.

The Intergroup Service Office, serving 18 groups in the greater Jacksonville area is supported by monthly donations from the groups, a monthly Intergroup meeting, an annual banquet and annual picnic. Any outsider at the banquet and picnic are usually guests of the A.A. members.

A majority of the groups donate to G.S.O. each year. The true spirit of self-support is spreading, but there is room for improvement. Many of the small groups in Jacksonville meet in churches, by request of the church. None pay rent as such, but donate to their fund for the needy. One such group splits their collection down the middle — one-half goes to the church, the other to Intergroup Service.

—Harry G., Northern Florida

NEED TO EDUCATE NEW MEMBERS

Rotation and principles before personalities are two of the foundation stones upon which the Alcoholics Anonymous program is built. When these are disregarded results can be disastrous for the group.

There is, I admit, the personality, strong and full of ego, that sells itself instead of the principles of the A.A. program. There again, each of us is responsible for not educating the new members to the fact that each of us should learn the foundation principles of this God-given program and put them first.

There should be no responsibility relegated to anyone for an indefinite period. It should be for a specified length of time, then automatically a change should be made.

When we are allowed to take over any job for too long a period of time, we are apt to become possessive and feel competent to handle things according to our ideas without consulting the group. This causes resentment and friction, which destroys unity.

No one member can combat such a situation alone, but if you have a group working together to uphold our principles and Traditions, this problem will not exist and your group will grow and prosper.

—Lib M., Northeast Texas.

STRESS PRINCIPLES OF A.A.

In many groups today the new member is told to listen. The sponsor and the group as a whole expect that this new member will get all the help he needs from what is said around the table. This is not true, because when we come to A.A. we come with many, many problems. But we do know that with the help of the Big Book, the Twelve Steps and the group, all of these things can be handled.

Sponsorship to me is one of the things that accomplishes the most for both the sponsor and the newcomer. When a new member comes into A.A., he or she should immediately be given a sponsor. Now I don't mean that he belongs to the sponsor. He belongs to the group and he is a group responsibility. He should always be considered as such. The importance of his sobriety is the importance of our sobriety, because this new man is the life blood of the continuation of our Fellowship.

We cannot talk too much about unity within the group — unity of purpose, unity of mind, unity of fellowship. It is important that we should always stress the principles of A.A., especially principles before personalities. When we do not understand a fellow A.A., we hold our peace, rather than say something about him, because we could be wrong. This, I think, is principle.

If we always remember the principles that our co-founders gave us in the Big Book and "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions," I believe the growth of our Fellowship will continue forever.

—Roy S., So. Illinois.

HOSPITALITY

Delegates voiced special thanks again in 1968 for the time and effort given by members of the Hospitality Committee in providing Delegates' wives with entertainment, sight-seeing tours, visits to N.Y.C. Intergroup and Al-Anon headquarters, TV shows, museum tours, shopping trips and other activities, not the least of which was a hospitality suite where from 40 to 80 people a day dropped in to chat with local A.A. members who were on duty to serve coffee and give advice and direction to anyone needing it.

A.A. Intergroups Seen Spur to Unity, Growth

Unity

Report

At the present time, we have 136 Central Offices listed at G.S.O. However, a great many of these fall in the category of an Intergroup Committee, rather than an actual office. Such an office should fulfill A.A.'s primary purpose in providing a focal point of inquiry for alcoholics seeking help. It is also a place where nonalcoholics can come for help and information. It is the show window of A.A. in the community, often responsible for local public information. It is a truly vital artery of A.A. life in the community.

Even as the purposes of Central Offices are the same, it appears (from answers to our questionnaire) that some of their problems are the same also. One of the chief problems of Central Offices is that of financial support.

The average salary for a full-time secretary or manager is less than \$65.00 a week. And of all the questionnaires returned, only two indicated there was any hospitalization coverage for the secretary or manager, and only one had an annuity plan arranged for retirement.

Most Central Offices rely upon group pledges and contributions, some personal contributions, and sales of literature for their support. However, most offices find this insufficient, with the result that annual banquets, anniversary picnics and the like are also used as a source of revenue.

There is frequently confusion about the differences between a General Service Committee and their Central Office. A Central Office, of course, provides services to groups locally, and carries the message to the individual seeking A.A. The General Service Committee on the other hand, is more concerned with matters which will guarantee that A.A. will always be available to the alcoholic. Another problem in communication has been the one of communication between General Service Offices and General Service Committees. Thus, an effort is being made to bring local Intergroups and Central Offices into the Third Legacy communications network at the local level.

—Eve M., G.S.O. Staff,
Staff Coordinator.

OFFICES MAINTAIN 'HEARTLINE'

Presentation

Although unity means oneness and Intergroup refers to many, they can be blended together beautifully to increase strength, sobriety and growth in our

great Fellowship.

The best example that I know of to explain the working of an Intergroup is the New York Intergroup which covers Metropolitan New York, a portion of the State of Connecticut and a section of New Jersey. There are over 300 groups which belong to it, serve with it, and benefit greatly from it.

An office is maintained full time with a paid secretary who is a member, and a rotating group of volunteers who maintain the answering of the telephones which is known as the "Heartline." When a person calls he is talked to, and told there is help and hope for him, and assistance will be freely given, within a very short time.

Unity is fully expressed by all of the groups when the program chairmen of each group get together at a central location to exchange meetings. This is done on a quarterly basis.

In reference to publications at the Intergroup Office here in New York, an A.A. meeting list booklet is published at regular intervals, listing all of the groups in the area, the nights of their meetings, the type of meeting, the time of the meeting, and the complete address as to the location of the meeting. This is a very helpful tool which is used faithfully by the members.

Our Intergroup Office gives help to anyone who calls wanting help. It will tell any person who calls for a location of a meeting all the necessary information. The Intergroup Office cooperates fully with all the groups who are members and at the present time every group in the Metropolitan New York Area is a member of the New York Intergroup. Even if groups cannot or do not contribute financially to the Intergroup Treasury, they are still welcome to all of the vital and necessary services. At the same time they are asked to share in the work of running an Intergroup which is such a vital and important service.

We know that each group is separate, and Intergroup brings groups together which makes a oneness. And what is oneness but unity; hence Intergroup or Central Office plays a real role in promoting unity between groups.

—Tom M., Southeastern New York

TRADITIONS GUIDE ACTIVITIES

The harmonious handling of local services is done better in the older, well-established groups. New groups still have their growing pains and have a lack of proven information available. Trial and error teaches us that close attention to the 12 Traditions is the answer to most of our in-group and intergroup activities. The enthusiasm of the newcomer is sometimes dampened by the conservatism of the long-timer. But honest attention and practice in A.A. principles usually answers the questions raised. Lately G.S.R.'s are realizing that they fill an important niche in A.A. welfare. Committee Members are becoming familiar with all group problems and things are — every day, in every way — getting better.

A sick person should get immediate attention. This is particularly true of the sick alcoholic. We should do all that is possible to have our answering service fulfill that need. Get help quickly to the alcoholic who is sick enough to ask for help. First of all the community must know how help is reached. Larger towns, with enough members to support it, are using the so-called Central Office as a place of call. These are operated by the use of one or two paid employees who are trained to handle distress signals. Smaller towns have the so-called Intergroup facility which depends on a commercial answering service to route the incoming calls to strategically located and available A.A. members.

Public information programs should be presented in an interesting fashion. The cold news release type is not enough. Radio, TV, and newspapers are more than glad to cooperate. They appreciate professional-type material. Such material is available through channels at G.S.O.

—Ray G., Colorado

A.A. Groups Self-Governing, but Should Consider Others

Presentation

Paraphrasing one of our Traditions: Each group should be self-governing, *except* in matters affecting *anyone* who is not a member of the group doing the

governing. A self-governing group of Alcoholics Anonymous has complete freedom to dictate, by group conscience matters such as, where meetings are held, procedures, and distribution of contributions.

When a group such as a fellowship or club has a telephone, it offers a unique opportunity for recruiting new members. But the fact that there is this opportunity carries with it certain obligations and responsibilities to other groups in the area. This phone will receive calls for help which I am sure most groups handle in a most efficient manner. This is not where the primary source of responsibility to other groups lies. This lies in the other multitude of calls from other sources, such as schools, churches, and service clubs which would like information and in some instances a member of A.A. to speak to their group.

All too frequently these phones are answered by newcomers, who are not familiar with how these calls should be handled. Any time this happens, other groups and A.A. as a whole are affected, sometimes irreparably. When a group has this situation, it is the responsibility of the group to make certain that the people who answer the phone are either trained in how to handle this type call or else are advised to whom these calls should be directed. The most satisfactory method of dealing with this type situation is a Central Office or answering service, supported and governed by several groups in an area.

—Pat S., Northern California.

A.A. MEETINGS VARY

Interview Time

What types of meeting are held in your area? Delegates gave a number of answers to this question, among which were the following:

1. Open for alcoholics and their guests.

2. Closed discussion, for alcoholics only.

3. Open discussion, for alcoholics and guests.

4. Breakfast meetings, midnight meetings and luncheon meetings.

5. Men's, women's, young people's and beginners' meetings.

6. Institutional — jails, hospitals.

7. Steps, slogans, Traditions, and Fifth Step meetings.

8. A & P (alcohol and pill) meetings.

9. Retreats, Alkathons and Marathons.

10. Round Robin, area meetings and special public meetings.

Ask-It-Basket

Q. Is there a guideline for maintenance of a prudent reserve in treasuries of group, Intergroup, Central Office, or General Service Assembly?

A. *This varies a good deal from area to area. At G.S.O., the reserve is an amount roughly equal to the cost of servicing the groups for nine months. One Central Office maintains a three-months' cash reserve. In one area assembly any amount in excess of \$300 was sent out of the treasury at the end of the year, and a two-months' reserve is maintained.*

Q. The pamphlet "Cooperation but not Affiliation" suggests that any member who is employed by an outside agency keep his activities as such an employee, separate from his A.A. membership activity. Would Delegates consider that an A.A. member, employed as an alcoholic consultant in a rehab or state hospital be able to serve as a G.S.R. of his institutions group? And, two, should a paid employee of an alcoholism agency also serve as a trusted servant of A.A.?

A. *After considerable discussion the sense of the meeting was that the employee should be able to serve as group G.S.R. and that "no A.A. members should be barred from holding any A.A. office because of his occupation."*

Q. What purpose is served by sending Delegates duplicate contribution statements and why do some Delegates receive information about groups not in their areas?

A. *First, duplicate statements enable the Delegate to see what his area is doing in the way of contributions. He can tell which groups have contributed and which have not. He can then contact the non-contributing groups, personally, or through his Committee Members. Second, it is difficult to be sure of the geographic boundaries of a Delegate's area, because requests for this information are not always answered. G.S.O. asks Delegates to cooperate by sending in maps, clearly defining their areas.*

EVE M. TO RETIRE

Eve M., Staff Member at the General Service Office for the past 16 years, plans to retire effective Sept. 1, 1968, it was announced at the Conference. She plans to travel extensively, visiting A.A.'s throughout the world. Florida will be her home base.

G.S.R.'s Catalytic Agents

Between G.S.O. and Membership

Unity

Presentation

The point here is what we can do to promote unity in our areas and in A.A. as a whole; then, how we may motivate others to put their talents to work. The key to good organization in A.A. is effective G.S.R.'s. A good organization also has effective utilization of Committee Members. They are the catalytic agents between the General Services of A.A., and the grass-roots membership. Finally, the Delegate and other state officers must be fully informed to help supply real motivation and inspiration.

The Regional Trustee has no direct relationship to local services. Delegates, like Trustees, are not representatives of areas in the usual political sense. The Delegates do not go to the General Service Conference to logroll special benefits for their respective areas, nor do Trustees go to meetings of the General Service Board of A.A. to logroll special benefits for their respective regions. They all go primarily to render a service to world A.A., to insure that A.A. will continue to function as a whole. However, both should bring with them the viewpoints of their own areas on such problems as may affect A.A. as a whole. Trustees and Delegates are always servants, never senators.

There are also many differences between Delegates and Trustees. A Trustee is not a super-delegate. As Trustees they see that A.A.'s world center of communication, G.S.O., really serves the groups and other alcoholics. They are custodians of funds received, of the 12 Steps and 12 Traditions, and are the legal guardians of the name Alcoholics Anonymous. They endeavor to keep the A.A. name from being drawn into public controversy and to protect the anonymity of A.A. members everywhere.

Finally, then, in order to best serve A.A. as a whole, a Trustee must know when to speak up and when to speak out. A Trustee, as well as a Delegate and G.S.R. must be informed on activities in his area, thereby serving as a sounding board and helping to keep the lines of communication open between the area and G.S.O. —Eric B., Regional Trustee, Pacific Region.

DISTRICT MEETINGS IMPORTANT

District meetings are very important in any area of A.A. They are a necessity and must be maintained in order to keep open the line of communication among groups and to G.S.O. If we do not continue to have regular meetings, we will lose this line of communication.

Each of the five districts in my area has a meeting once a month, as a rule. The agenda is sent out by the secretary to the G.S.R. prior to the meeting.

When you have these regular meetings, you should try for as much discussion as possible and work to solve problems right away. Don't let them wait. Sometimes we invite all our general membership, in order to make them feel they are a part of this program. They ask questions and we answer them in a way we feel will provide the solution for our area. I firmly believe that our Committee Members are responsible and dedicated, working with an open mind at these meetings.

We have a unique line of communication with the Police Department. At first, we just put a listing under the Police Station and they would answer "North Bay Police" and most of the drunks would hang up. Then they came up with a solution. We put up a separate line and the policeman picking up the phone says "A.A." Then they give out telephone numbers and help individuals find this wonderful program.

—Jack R., Alt. Delegate, Northeastern Ontario.

RESPONSIBILITIES OF DELEGATE

The G.S. Delegate acts as a link in the chain between the A.A. General Service Office, the groups, G.S.R.'s and area Committee Members and Delegates Committee, area conferences and A.A. as a whole. In carrying out his functions, he is expected:

- To help organize and carry on district and area assembly meetings.
- To carry the message of G.S.O. at area assembly, conferences.
- To protect A.A. from anonymity breaks at the level of radio, TV and news media.
- To help carry the message through public information.
- To help new groups in their organization as well as the work of Intergroups or Central Offices.
- To carry the message of finances to area Committee Members, G.S.R.'s and A.A. groups as a whole.
- To have better direction for literature and mail from G.S.O. to the groups by strengthening the G.S.R.'s in his area.
- To utilize the knowledge of ex officio Delegates, Committee Members and others to recharge them in G.S.O. work.

Communications is a valuable key in solving our present and future problems. Our Central Offices and Public Information Committees should continue to advise on how to better communicate with the general public, clergy, doctors, courts and others. In educating and informing these people, the road will be made easier for the still suffering alcoholic who will be coming into A.A. in the future. —Jim F., Southern Minnesota.

Ask-It-Basket

- Q. What do we do when we receive a call for help from an individual who we know is drunk at the time, who we presume wants sympathy and someone to baby-sit him, who would not likely see us when sober? Should we answer this?
- A. One Delegate expressed gratitude that the A.A. who called on her didn't pass judgment or give up. Another Delegate said he continued to answer repeated calls from one individual who finally got sober and stayed that way.

Area Highlights

ARIZONA — The Alcolthon held at Phoenix from noon Christmas Eve to noon Christmas day helps newcomers and others pass through the holiday season without trouble. From a small start seven years ago, with 20 groups participating and about 120 attending, the Alcolthon has grown to where there are 50 groups participating and more than 600 people registered from seven states. Meetings are held around the clock and refreshments are provided in a separate room. P.I. results are excellent with radio, TV and newspaper coverage over the years.

—Charles D.

ALASKA — The Fifth A Month Club was formed to raise money for General Service and to help defray expenses of the Delegate during Conference time. Requirements for membership are one year of sobriety and financial stability to afford about \$20 per month per meeting. There is a dinner meeting with a spouse or friend as guest. It is primarily a social affair and there have been no incidents so far. Donations are accepted from A.A. members only.

—Angus J.

ALBERTA — A.A. members do a lot of visiting from the cities out into the surrounding towns in order to help keep smaller groups active and strong. The yearly conference offers old friends a chance to see each other, as well as a chance to get plenty of good A.A. An effort is made to get as many of the smalltown group members involved in the actual work of the conference as possible.

—Ken K.

CALIFORNIA (Southern Coastal) — A.A. members in my area are showing a steadily growing interest in the Three Legacies of A.A. and the personal responsibility for each of us to accept and maintain this guardianship. This is being shown with an increasing number of district service meetings and workshops and with an impressive number of large general membership meetings totally dedicated to service.

—Warren S.

CALIFORNIA (San Diego) — There was a warm discussion in our area on whether a proposed young people's group would conflict with others. It was pointed out, however, that many new groups have been started over the years and most seem to be doing well. If it wasn't for people forming new groups there would be only one big group. That would be the extent of the program, and we would not have A.A. in my area.

—Bill B.

CALIFORNIA (Northern Interior) — There is a healthy interest in our area in all aspects of the program which express unity. There is good cooperation from all Committee Members. We find, however, that the smaller groups need more communication with Delegates and Committee Members, so we make more of an effort to visit their meetings in person. There is now a Central Office in Fresno which means better handling of Twelfth Step calls and improved unity and communication.

—Howard T.

DELAWARE — Our area is big enough and spread out over both urban and rural populations so that membership is varied, yet small enough so we see each other frequently and build up a feeling of unity. Our G.S.R. quarterly meeting and annual state assembly keep our lines of communication open. One area of discussion lately has been regarding the pros and cons of more organizational activities. In the meantime, however, we grow a little here and there and do the best we can.

—Margie N.

GEORGIA — Particular emphasis has been placed on achieving unity in our area this year. We encourage our Committee Members to hold monthly area meetings. These meetings are rotated so that each group may be host. Before the meeting, G.S.R.'s discuss problems and seek solutions so they may achieve closer unity. The open area meeting helps all members enlarge their participation in A.A. We also ask Committee Members to visit each group in their area at least once a month.

—Joe C.

IDAHO — The key to personal, sustained sobriety is responsibility. That responsibility must extend over the whole of our lives, to ourselves, and to all those persons with whom we are in contact. To be responsible means to care. If someone has not cared enough, we would not be here today. For the record, let it be shown that my area accepts its responsibility to any and all who would share with us the healing fellowship of A.A.

—Gordon L.

ILLINOIS (Northern) — We have recently started regular G.S.R. meetings. They have proven very interesting and create a lot of activity among the groups in the area. We have also made up a meeting list for all groups. This has done a tremendous job and helped to bring more unity to the groups in the state. Cooperation with the Council on Alcoholism is very good with all groups in the area.

—Joe F.

INDIANA (Southern) — The problems of alcoholism as viewed by psychologists, probation officers, policemen and others have been featured in a series of newspaper stories in Evansville recently. Evansville groups themselves have also been the subject of news stories with careful adherence to the Anonymity Tradition.

—Toy E.

KANSAS — Currently the state Committee is considering a plan to realign the A.A. districts of Kansas. With the expansion that has occurred in the number of A.A. groups, we find that even two Committee Members are not enough to do the job in one district. Thus, we plan to increase the number of districts as well as Committee Members in order to improve communications between groups, G.S.R.'s and the Committee Members, as well as to create and maintain group and individual interest in local, state and national affairs.

—Bill L.

KENTUCKY — Two facts are evident in Kentucky: One, there is an increasing number of new groups. Two, there is a growing number of area intergroup meetings being held. These usually take the form of a dinner meeting with a speaker. Some areas have the groups take turns providing the entire meal and take up a collection for expenses, while others ask each member to provide a dish. All these meetings are well supported since they afford an excellent opportunity to meet A.A. neighbors and have a good meeting.

—Frank R.

MAINE — With A.A. membership increasing in the state we have six counseling centers and two half-way houses. We are trying to carry the message to the alcoholic through radio and television, as well as through an answering service at a local hospital. This has provided a great response from those who desired help, but did not know who to contact, or were unaware that A.A. was in the area.

—Lloyd Y.

MANITOBA — Never have we had so many members so enthusiastically engaged in A.A. affairs. G.S.R.'s presently in service enjoy and benefit from a January "one-day school" for G.S.R.'s; a spring provincial assembly and a fall meeting. Even though groups are frequently many miles apart, most areas hold monthly area Committee meetings which help our assembly meetings to function more smoothly, efficiently and productively.

—Tom G.

MARYLAND — After attaining a measure of sobriety we begin to learn of unity and the Traditions. We find that the average recovered alcoholic's concept of service seldom extends beyond the willingness to answer a call on a bad night and put a dime or a dollar in the basket. We find that few groups ever have G.S.C. information and pamphlets on the literature racks. We need more attractive and imaginative literature on General Service and the knowledge among our membership that every regular contribution to G.S.O. is true service.

—Ben V.

Area Highlights

MASSACHUSETTS (Western) — All the Three Legacies of Unity, Recovery and Service are of equal importance and interdependent upon each other, much the same as all of us in A.A. depend upon each other. One of the earliest principles learned in A.A. is that of keeping the doors open. When one of the older groups announced meetings were being discontinued because of lagging interest, local A.A. members got together to find a new meeting place and provide support to the group. Now the group is active again, and other groups are helping. —*Wilfred McM.*

MICHIGAN (Western) — There is great interest in finding new ways to reach alcoholics and to inform the public about alcoholism, with the thought that this information will sift down to those who still suffer. Groups and individuals have sponsored various types of programs, which are still too new to evaluate. One group cooperates with caseworkers in the charitable field. Where interest is shown the group follows up with literature and Twelfth Step calls. —*Don W.*

MINNESOTA (Northern) — We are continuing the policy of "cooperation but not affiliation" with citizen groups which are becoming increasingly aware and concerned with the problem of alcoholism. Sparked by a study which recommended establishment of a halfway house in Duluth, civic-minded citizens proceeded to establish and operate such a facility. This is the beginning of an area program, implemented by a concerned citizenry, which cannot but help the alcoholic who still suffers. —*Dave H.*

MISSISSIPPI — Groups in one of our districts now hold what we call round-robin meetings each month, sponsored by a different group each time. These meetings create an extra interest among members and sometimes entire families attend together, as Alateen and Al-Anon speakers are also scheduled. All speakers are from other areas and the meetings run about two hours. —*Malvin P.*

MONTANA — If any program for treatment of alcoholism among Indians is to be successful, it must be based on the same knowledge and principles that would guide us in working out a program for any other group. Contributing factors for alcoholism among Indians include: chronic unemployment; lack of job opportunities; substandard living conditions; lack of education; cultural transition and dependency fostered by government paternalism. —*Joseph B.*

NEBRASKA — Somewhere we have failed the still suffering alcoholic. Too many attend a few meetings and then drift back into their old drinking habits. If we cannot be enthusiastic about sponsorship, then we have not found the love and happiness this Fellowship has to offer. Love for our fellow men and happiness within ourselves will come only after sharing our time and experience with other alcoholics. —*James G.*

NEW BRUNSWICK — P.E.I. — Much of the success of A.A. in our assembly has been due to the tireless dedication of good Committee Members. Where there is an active Committee Member, there also is A.A. at its best. The theme: "...personal recovery depends upon A.A. unity" requires that we all work together for the good of A.A. as a whole. In addition to round-ups and conferences, we have been holding monthly area meetings which have been very successful. —*Bill G.*

NEW JERSEY (Southern) — Because of much favorable publicity, A.A. is well known at the public level. Most members in this area were first told about A.A. by an employer, doctor, judge, clergyman, family member, or other informed nonalcoholics. I do not propose that we break anonymity at the public level, but suggest that those maintaining personal anonymity re-

consider. If there are good reasons for maintaining anonymity at this level, there are often as many good reasons for breaking it. —*Aaron K.*

NEW HAMPSHIRE — State assembly meetings are well attended, especially when we consider that 20 per cent of the groups in the state used to conduct all of the business. An Institutional Committee has been formed and is becoming increasingly active, especially at the state hospital which needs the most attention now. Currently, the Institutional Committee plans to meet with administrators of the hospital to share their views in the reorganization of the alcoholic treatment program. —*Neil G.*

NEW MEXICO — Most areas in New Mexico are having more intergroup meetings and exchanges of speakers and ideas. We maintain contact with all groups, gather information of various activities in the area and compile a news bulletin which is mailed to all groups and many individuals. Still, it seems that too many calls for help go unanswered or to other agencies, as though it is easier to let them do what we could and should do for ourselves. —*Bob H.*

NEW YORK (H/M/B) — A.A. growth in the area has increased substantially of late, with twelve new groups in the past year. This growth is reflected in greater attendance at Committee meetings as well as an increased number of G.S.R.'s, successful participation in the New York State Conference and support of G.S.O. Our public information activity is currently concentrated on the medical profession and we are making great inroads in the smaller countries. —*Chuck D.*

NEW YORK (Western) — Today we have A.A. meetings in almost all of the institutions in the area and we are finding it much easier to get speakers than it was a few years back. Requests for public information speakers have more than doubled in the past year and the number is increasing every day as just about every type of organization imaginable is requesting speakers or information regarding Alcoholics Anonymous. Just as the requests have increased, so has the public information committee grown to provide qualified members to fill the requests coming in. —*Bud S.*

NORTH DAKOTA — We have recently begun to invite speakers from outside agencies to open meetings to tell us of their problems. If it is within the scope of A.A., we try to help. We, in turn, make an effort to speak to outside agencies to tell them where we are, how they can contact us and what we offer the alcoholic who is still suffering. More G.S.R.'s are attending state meetings and we ask each to bring an A.A. guest if possible. This helps us show that we have guidelines and help from G.S.O. Usually they go back to their groups with a great deal more enthusiasm for service. —*Hal V.*

OHIO (Northeast) — MICHIGAN (Southeast) — Unity is no problem in my area. We cooperate with Intergroup, setting up meetings which will not interfere with theirs, and vice versa. In our setup we have a Chairman of the General Service Assembly and seven Committee Members. Formerly, Committee Members did not have too much to do. This year, however, they are taking care of all of the detail work involved with our state General Service Office. This has helped a great deal. —*George M.*

OHIO (Southwest Ohio and Northern Kentucky) — Communication is sharing. We share our thoughts, our ideas, and our knowledge and experiences with each other. At our area assembly meetings we devote some time to a sharing session at which questions are answered regarding G.S.O., G.S.R.'s, Committee Members, and making the group more aware of its responsibilities. In discussing these questions we have become better informed and learned how others think and feel. Above all, we have learned to communicate. —*Bob F.*

Area Highlights

ONTARIO (Western) — Not only can cooperation between the General Service Committee and Central Office be improved, there is a great need for this improvement. The solution for friction between Intergroup and General Service Representatives is cooperation without intrusion or interference. With undertakings such as hospital, institutional and public information programs, it is important to have a unity of purpose in all areas in order to make the best possible use of manpower and finances.—*Wyn D.*

OREGON — When we see the definition of "unity" as "the quality of being one in spirit, sentiment and purpose," we realize how very important unity is to the alcoholic. When drinking we had no unity in any important area of our lives — families, society, or God. In A.A. we are expected to find unity in these areas when all we want to do is get sober. After a while, though, the miracle does happen and we accomplish this by working the Twelve Steps and carrying the message to the still suffering alcoholic.—*Ralph L.*

PUERTO RICO — Currently unity in Puerto Rico is at a low ebb, primarily because we are placing personalities before principles. Another reason for our lack of unity is because we have no Intergroup Office able to handle exchange of speakers and service in general. There was such an office at one time, but because there was no unity, it did not grow. However, our membership and groups are growing and we will continue prospering in sobriety as long as we keep practicing the Twelve Steps and Traditions.—*Manuel R.*

QUEBEC (English-speaking) — Tremendous growth has taken place here over a very large geographical area, with many new groups being started. Many are in isolated places. Communication has been difficult because of distances. However, great strides have been taken to achieve unity through education, example and attraction. Committee Members and G.S.R.'s, aware of their responsibilities, are very enthusiastic. A monthly bulletin is published and public information programs are extensive.—*Tony G.*

QUEBEC (French) — Since publication of our French Big Book in 1963, the number of A.A. groups in Quebec has gone up from 100 to 326 and we now have about 7,500 members. Three years ago we began publication of *La Vigne A.A.* which is modeled after the Grapevine. It is a 32-page magazine printed every two months. At present it pays its own printing expenses, but still needs some help from General Services of Quebec to take care of mailing and promotion expenses.—*Fernand I.*

RHODE ISLAND — There has been a great deal of increased activity in public information and in institutional work. As a result of personal letters sent to all churches, educational, medical and law enforcement agencies, requests for A.A. speakers have increased sharply. There is full coverage of institutions in Rhode Island with different groups participating each week. A sponsorship group is being formed to ease the return of prisoners into the community.—*Ruth L.*

SASKATCHEWAN — We are currently striving to attain G.S.R.'s for each group in the Province. All areas meet once a month. The Committee Member and his G.S.R.'s discuss each group's progress and problems. Then the G.S.R.'s report to their groups. We are also working on the idea of all groups having a G.S.R. "understudy" who takes a serious interest in the work and can follow through when the time comes.—*Jack C.*

SOUTH CAROLINA — Before we can work to achieve A.A. unity, we must work to achieve unity within ourselves by practicing the Twelve Steps. Second, we must have unity with the God of our understanding through Step Eleven. Then we can have unity with our fellow men. Through this unity we can serve oth-

ers and can place principles above personalities. Without unity within ourselves, with the God of our understanding and with others, our recovery is impossible.—*John M.*

SOUTH DAKOTA — Unity of purpose has contributed to the recent steady growth of A.A. membership in South Dakota as well as the younger age at which alcoholics are seeking help. There is also an increase in visits between groups and in the interest shown in the four state Committee meetings held each year. Our constantly improving communication between individual A.A.'s, state Committee and G.S.O. keeps us aware of service and our individual responsibilities.—*John B.*

TENNESSEE — A.A. at the state level has taken a new lease on life during the past two years. We now have much interest in the Institution Committee and each state assembly meeting has shown an increase in the attendance of G.S.R.'s. In addition, we now have a new quarterly publication on the doings of A.A. statewide. We are currently planning for the 1969 Southeastern Conference in Chattanooga. The state convention at Knoxville will be more or less a kickoff for this event.—*Tom M.*

TEXAS (Northwest) — For the first time all Committee Members have been elected according to Third Legacy procedures. This was accomplished due to the work of past Delegates. Their understanding of the importance of General Services made them work harder in attempting to organize the area. An answering service in the Lubbock area has been very effective in reaching many alcoholics who would not have otherwise found A.A. Newspapers, radio, and television also help us attract those who need help.—*George G.*

TEXAS (Southwest) — The third Annual Pre-G.S.O. Workshop was well attended by 77 G.S.R.'s and Committee Members, and we plan on having several district-level workshops during the year to discuss local problems. Although we are growing, we need more participation and cooperation between groups, many of which are small and geographically isolated. We are trying to give them all the help we can.—*Carl H.*

VERMONT — Group unity has shown healthy growth since formation of an active Institutional Committee, with nearly every group doing its part. This seems to have sparked interest enough to double attendance at state meetings. It has also helped us achieve better communications and better acceptance of our responsibility at the group level as well as contact with the very cooperative administration of these institutions.—*Orlando C.*

WISCONSIN (Northern) — In order to encourage unity among groups we are working to establish General Service Committees in various localities. These committees consist of two members from each group. They meet once a month to discuss social and educational progress of the groups. Interested professional people are welcome at these meetings. It has been suggested that if every member kept in mind the reason he came to A.A., as well as the reason he stayed in A.A., it would make for better unity.—*Paul W.*

WYOMING — Means of communication and reasonable proximity of groups are necessary ingredients to unity, and these factors are lacking in Wyoming which has a small population and a great expanse of land. Last year it required 20 days and 7,000 miles of car travel to carry the Conference message to each group in the state. Still, we do maintain a robust type of woodshed A.A. and we do keep it simple. We are unified as to purpose and principles.—*Merrill S.*

O.K. First A.A. Survey

Inside A.A.

Conference Action

Following presentation and discussion, Delegates approved a proposition to conduct a survey among A.A. members in order to gather more meaningful information regarding the effectiveness of the A.A. program of recovery.

Presentation

Probably no membership organization or group in the world knows as little about its members, in some ways, as we. Nor is this entirely accidental, since it is a long-standing policy of our Fellowship to keep no membership records or "case histories." But perhaps we go a little too far. For without in any way violating our cherished custom of keeping no membership records or case histories, it would certainly be possible for us to know a little more about ourselves than we now do.

In the past, only a few attempts have been made to learn anything about our Fellowship. Almost without exception, such attempts as have been made to compile statistics about A.A. have been made by "outsiders." Often, A.A. has cooperated with such efforts.

But never have we ourselves done a real study of our Fellowship. We believe that such a study would provide distinct benefits, not only to us, but to the many alcoholics whom we have not yet reached, for they might be motivated by such a study to seek help from us. Obviously, any survey that we ever do would be done anonymously, that is, the A.A. members filling out the questionnaires would not sign them. Thus, we at the General Service Office would not know, and would not want to know, who the individuals were who had participated. By the same token, the results of any such study or survey would be used with all due care.

After careful exploration, and following full discussions at both the Policy and General Service Board meetings, it was decided to conduct a "pilot survey." This was undertaken by the Regional Trustees, and as a result of their efforts, nine different groups scattered throughout the United States and Canada filled out questionnaires. Anonymously, of course. A total of 403 questionnaires were completed and returned to G.S.O. At the same time, a similar questionnaire was included in 200 copies of the Grapevine, selected at random.

—Bob H., Chairman, A.A. World Services.

WHAT WE CAN LEARN

The pilot survey was done with the help of Regional Trustees who each took the questionnaires to one group in their area. There were six questions:

1. When did you first come to A.A.?
2. When did you have your last drink?
3. When did you attend your last meeting before this one?
4. How often do you normally attend A.A. meetings?
5. How did you first hear about A.A.? Clergy, alcoholism agency, radio, TV, newspaper, magazine, other?
6. Male, female, approximate age?

What did we learn from this? In the first place, it was a pilot and we learned that it was easy and inexpensive to get this kind

of information. Second, we found that people were more than willing to fill out this questionnaire. The third thing we learned was that the questionnaires were answered with total honesty. You could tell by the marginal notes and by thumbing through that people were telling us the truth. Finally we think we proved we could get information of real value.

There are at least four ways that we can use it that would be useful, constructive and helpful to the Fellowship: (1) Dr. Norris and other members of the Board can use it in dealing with Government agencies with professional groups, national organizations, in order to open up more and more opportunities for A.A. to be of service; (2) We can make the information available to you for your use in institutions, hospitals and the agencies that you deal with; (3) We can use it for news releases, articles, magazines, newspapers, technical papers, television, radio, and (4) We can include it in literature for members and prospective members, and for newcomers in 12th Step work.

So we feel that with little effort from all of us this kind of a study can give us great dividends in expanding our opportunities to be of service.

—Bayard P., G.S.O. Trustee
Co-Chairman, Public Information Committee.

CONFERENCE REPORT AND CHARTER COMMITTEE

Conference Action

The Conference Report and Charter Committee of the General Service Conference took the following actions:

1. Recommended that a memorandum from the Southeast Regional Trustee, updating the terminology at the Conference Charter, be accepted as presented to the Committee for their review.
2. Reviewed and made initial recommendations concerning the draft of material submitted to them in connection with the revision of the "Third Legacy Manual," and agreed to further review this material and additional chapters referred to them. It is hoped this revision will be completed prior to the 19th Conference meeting. The reaction of the Committee to the initial material was that the format represented a great improvement.
3. The Committee agreed to review and return the rough draft of the Conference Report one week from date of its receipt.
4. Elected Gordon L., Idaho, Chairman.

Ask-It-Basket

- Q. Can you discuss the subject of Bill and Niacin in any detail?
- A. Such a discussion has no place at this Conference, since it has nothing to do with A.A. The General Service Board is on record as recognizing that niacin has nothing to do with the A.A. program. Bill concurs in this.

World Service Meeting to Help Overseas A.A.

Conference Action

Delegates voted unanimously that the first World Service Meeting be held in New York City, in the fall of 1969. The vote followed a background session during which Bill W. and Bob H. presented the proposal and discussed with

Delegates the preliminary steps that had been taken. Bill noted that such a meeting was the next logical step in helping to encourage development of service structures in other countries and areas where it is needed.

"Long ago it became apparent that New York could not forever provide complete General Services to all A.A. countries," he said, noting that the aim has been to let A.A. in other parts of the world take responsibility for its own services as soon as it becomes feasible, with G.S.O. standing entirely ready to encourage and assist as it has been doing for some years in the past.

"It is now our thought that a Conference to be made up of overseas countries of large A.A. population, should meet with us here in the fall of 1969," he said. "The Conference purpose would be to consider — in every aspect — the future development of world service. A tentative inquiry has already been launched as to the desirability of such an exploratory project and the overseas response has been most enthusiastic."

A SEVEN-POINT PROPOSAL

Bob H. submitted to Delegates the seven-point proposal of the Trustees' World Service Planning Committee as follows:

1. That the first World Service Meeting be held in New York City in the fall of 1969.
2. That each of the countries invited participate by sending two elected delegates. That both delegates may be A.A.'s or one A.A. and one non-A.A. That one of the two come from the General Service Board or overall Service Committee and that the other be a salaried or volunteer Staff Member capable of carrying out suggested procedures and responsibilities. Also, that five years of sobriety for the A.A. member is desirable, but two years should be required. And, that elections of delegates be conducted by Third Legacy procedures.
3. That the North American Conference participate by electing two Delegates at their "Area Delegates Only" Meeting in 1969. This should be done by Third Legacy electoral procedures. One Delegate to be elected from Panel 18, one from Panel 19.
4. That the Chairman of our General Service Board and the Manager of the General Service Office be voting delegates. Naturally, Bill W. will also be a voting member.
5. That all Trustees, Directors of A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine, and General Service Office and Grapevine Staffs may be invited as non-voting members as their experience is needed for sharing.

6. That the World Service Meeting Planning Committee continue to function and proceed with plans for the World Service Meeting and that this committee be authorized to determine the eligibility of additional countries who may wish to attend, as well as to handle any other questions that might arise in connection with this meeting.

7. That the General Service Board deposit \$5000 in a special account to be opened for purposes of initial financing of the World Service Meeting.

A NEED FOR WIDER SHARING

Report

As you may know, the International Committee was established in the fall of 1963 to meet a need for a wider sharing of A.A. experience in connection with the development and growth of A.A. groups outside the North American continent.

It is the duty of the committee to review the progress, problems and needs of overseas A.A., its growth and experience, and to make recommendations as to the sharing of service experience with foreign countries.

One tool developed over the past year to help achieve this aim is the Overseas Service Manual which contains much of the material formulated over the years by G.S.O. in advising and counseling overseas groups.

Early in its deliberations the International Committee noted a direct relationship between the growth of A.A. in a foreign country and the degree to which A.A. literature was available in the language of that country. Recommendations regarding literature translation needs have therefore been an important function of the committee. We have established a policy for translation of literature, set up guidelines for establishing committees and evaluation of translations, and contacted volunteers in this country who are available to check translations to see that they are as faithful as possible to the originals.

—Niles P., Chairman
Trustees' International Committee

WHEN TO REVEAL MEMBERSHIP

Interview Time

When is revealing your A.A. membership not an anonymity break? Delegates gave a number of answers to this question, among which were the following:

1. When on a Twelfth Step call.
2. When speaking to clergymen, doctors, employers, and others.
3. At meetings of non-A.A.'s when you are sure there will be no mention in the press, radio, or TV.
4. Whenever it might help another alcoholic, but never at the public level.

A.A.W.S. Sets New Records

Inside A.A.

Report

A.A.W.S. is a membership corporation and is responsible for the employment of G.S.O. personnel, for preparing and controlling the operation budget, and for publishing and distributing all Conference-approved books and pamphlets.

G.S.O.'s administrative group is made up of the Chairman of General Services, the Controller, Staff Members, and the other Supervisors of Departments. There are 43 full-time employees, and seven part-time. (This is exclusive of the Grapevine's personnel.)

PUBLISHING: Distribution of A.A. literature increased substantially over 1966. Sales of books and pamphlets ran 30.5% ahead of last year. After paying its own share of overhead, the publishing operation contributed \$50,000 in support of other services.

In 1967, A.A.W.S. authorized free distribution of 153,300 pieces of literature with an actual cost of \$4,656, plus shipping costs. The practice of pricing foreign language literature to meet the needs of low-economy countries was continued. Thus about 10% of our total literature output is distributed gratis.

SHIPPING: The year 1967 was one of greatly increased activity for Shipping. As General Services grow, a heavier workload is placed upon the shipping operation. Al Cryan supervises six full-time and five part-time employees to keep abreast of the schedule. Last year the department handled 70,443 incoming mail items (inquiries, group letters, contributions, orders) and sent out 220,000 mail items (including bulletin mailings). Book and pamphlet orders accounted for 49,414 packages shipped.

THIRD G.S.O. FILMSTRIP

Delegates to the 18th General Service Conference reviewed a new filmstrip which depicts activities of the G.S.O. Staff in providing service to A.A. members and groups throughout the world. The filmstrip with sound track is available from G.S.O. for showing within A.A.

ARCHIVES: Nell Wing, Bill's secretary, heads up this department. One of the oldest services at G.S.O., our library increases yearly, with new editions and printings of books, pamphlets, tapes, reports, directories, photographs, film prints, group histories, and many more items.

CLERICAL/STENO: The Clerical/Steno Department, supervised by Kleina Jones and Susan Dolinsky, employs 14 girls, a receptionist, a switchboard operator, two full-time Spanish translators, and a part-time French translator. Approximately 58,000 letters, reports, and memorandums were handled by this department in 1967.

ACCOUNTING: Under the direction of Dennis Manders and Charles Columbia, four full-time employees and one part-time employee processed 16,645 orders and 16,530 contribution remittances during 1967. There were also payrolls to be prepared, bills

to be processed and paid, the general books to be kept, statistics to be maintained and periodic analyses to be made of literature costs, payroll comparisons, etc.

RECORDS: Under the direction of Rose Failla, Supervisor, this department in 1967 set up records for 1,730 new groups. They were responsible for making some 8,500 changes of addresses, and recording many other changes. Their primary responsibility: the compilation of three Directories — World, Hospital and Prison.

—Bob H., Chairman
A.A. World Services, Inc.

SHARING WITHIN A.A.

The Service Coordinator's primary responsibility is to improve the present methods of sharing with all of A.A. the information available at G.S.O. and to observe trends which indicate new service needs.

The two primary service tools, both of which are mailed to more than 17,000 on the G.S.O. mailing list, are:

1. *The World Directory:* the Records Department compiles this Directory and it is published in April of each year. It contains a list of all reported A.A. groups, clubs, Loners, Central Offices, etc. round the world. It is "Confidential" and to be used for A.A. purposes only. One copy is sent free to each group and additional copies are available for sale to A.A. members only.

2. *Box 4-5-9:* This is a bulletin sharing A.A. news round the world. It is compiled and mailed every other month to the approximately 17,000 on the G.S.O. mailing list. The Service Coordinator is the editor, and Nell Wing is the production editor. Through *Box 4-5-9*, A.A.'s are kept informed on new services, new literature, new trends in A.A., the growth and development of A.A. around the world, calendar of regional conferences; new and old A.A. problems and the overall thinking and experience concerning them.

Two World Editions of *Box 4-5-9* were added to our services in November of 1967. One in French which goes to all French-speaking groups and Loners, and one in Spanish which goes to Spanish-speaking groups, Loners, etc.

For New Groups: Some 1,700 new groups were added to G.S.O.'s mailing list last year. They were all written, sent information, a *World Directory*, complimentary literature packages, and a *Group Handbook* was included for the North American groups.

Other General Service tools include "Guidelines" which are available on request. These Guidelines include: Armed Forces Groups; Central Offices and Committees; Clubs, Conventions, Conferences and Areas or Regional A.A. Get-Togethers; Courts; Institutional Committees; Public Information Committees and Alcoholic Rehabilitation Centers.

—Hazel R., G.S.O. Staff
Service Coordinator

World Directory in Two Sections: U.S. and Canada, and Overseas

Conference Action

Following presentation and discussion, Delegates approved a proposition to issue the *World Directory* in two editions — one for the United States and Canada, the second for other countries.

Presentation

The *World Directory* is a most vital A.A. informational tool. It provides a mailing address, and meeting nights and phone contacts, where applicable, for all groups, clubs, contacts, Loners, Central Offices, Intergroup Committees, Institutional Committees, General Service Boards, General Service Offices, Literature Distribution Centers and North American Conference Delegates and Chairmen for A.A. around the world, based on information received at G.S.O.

The Directory listings are compiled from Information Cards which are mailed to the G.S.O. mailing list in September of each year, with a deadline of December 1st for their return for inclusion in the spring *Directory*. If no card is returned, the address and telephone contacts listed for the past year are carried again.

The policies concerning the *World Directory* — its purpose, use and distribution — have come through Conference Advisory Action:

First, the *World Directory* is "confidential" and is intended for A.A. members only to share information and activities. It is not to be used as a mailing list for any form of solicitation or any commercial venture. Second, in regard to listings: "Traditionally, any two or more alcoholics meeting together for purposes of sobriety may consider themselves an A.A. group, provided that, as a group, they are self-supporting and have no outside affiliation. Groups listed in the *Directory* are listed at their own request. A Directory listing does not constitute or imply approval or endorsement of any group's approach to, or practice of, the traditional A.A. program."

Whenever G.S.O. is advised of a Directory misuse, the persons involved are reminded of the Conference policy. It is also suggested that A.A. members, receiving such a mailing request they be removed from the sender's mailing list, if they so desire.

And now, for a bit of history concerning the *World Directory*:

In 1941, it started as a two-page mimeographed listing. The list grew until the spring of 1949 brought forth a paper-bound book called "A.A. Group Listings." This first book listed some 2700 groups and 75,000 members. In 1953, a group-experience section was added and until 1958 it was called "The Group Handbook and Directory." A.A. growth caused the Handbook information to be deleted in 1958 and it became known as the *World Directory* and still carries that name and general format.

Now, in 1968, the *World Directory* is again in need of a change of format. First, it has reached the printing maximum in its present form, and the necessary change in binding methods would greatly increase our costs. Second, the International Committee has recommended that meeting places and times be added to the present mailing address and phone contacts for the overseas portion of the *World Directory*. The reason for this request was the many reports from overseas travelers, indicating they were unable to make contact by phone due to inadequate phone

service or incorrect number or language difficulty. Thus, if they had meeting information, they could have gone to the meeting place.

To include this additional needed information would increase the overseas pages by at least one-third.

Thus, the Directors of A.A.W.S., Inc. would like the Conference's thinking on separating the present *World Directory* into two Directories — one for overseas and one for the U.S. and Canada. This would enable the Directories to better serve A.A. overseas and also adequately serve the U.S. and Canada.

The production expense would be about the same as for the present format — if divided into two Directories. The mailing cost would be less because the groups would receive only one Directory (either overseas or U.S. and Canada) at no charge. However, both Directories would be available to all A.A.'s for purchase.

If the Conference approves the division of the present *World Directory*, each Directory would contain maps and a summary of A.A. Round the World.

—Hazel R., G.S.O. Staff,
Service Coordinator

SHARING BOX 4-5-9

Interview Time

Do G.S.R.'s share the *World Directory* and Box 4-5-9 with the groups?

Delegates noted that this varies from group to group — with some G.S.R.'s making a special point for sharing this material with other members and others regarding it as their personal mail. Most noted, however, that more and more G.S.R.'s are being educated to pass this information on to the groups.

Ask-It-Basket

Q. At state conferences, how much is Al-Anon involved? Or are they part of a state conference at all?

A. The Twelve Traditions of both A.A. and Al-Anon suggest they "Cooperate but not Affiliate" — thus they function quite separately at group, Intergroup, area and General Service levels. A.A. Convention Committees often invite Al-Anon to participate by having their own separate programs. With prior agreement, expenses for facilities and speakers are paid from A.A. Convention Funds. In keeping with A.A.'s Tradition of self-support and non-endorsement, all monies (registration, etc.) are handled by A.A. and any profit is for A.A., not Al-Anon, as it is an A.A. Convention. Al-Anon speakers may only be included on A.A. programs, on meetings entitled "Friends of A.A." or some similar title where two or three non-A.A. friends share what A.A. means to them. Guidelines on this subject are available from G.S.O.

Correspondence Primary Purpose

Inside A.A.

Report

Correspondence is the lifeline of group sharing and is our primary service. Each Staff Member is assigned a geographic area for which she is responsible, as far as all correspondence in that area is concerned (exceptions are Central Office and Loner correspondence handled by the Staff Coordinator, and correspondence from Committee Members and Delegates, handled by the Conference Secretary). The regions assigned to each Staff Member fall into the Trustee regions, with the exception of Canada, which all of us share.

Each Staff Member shares in all the correspondence through the device of circulating folders, in which all correspondence is placed each day. Thus each one of us has an opportunity to share in the many facets of the correspondence received at G.S.O.; letters from alcoholics seeking help, from families, from doctors, from industry — from groups asking questions, groups sharing their experience, P.I. Committees endeavoring to carry the message, Loners trying to stay sober, Internationalists visiting far-away groups.

During the past year, Staff Members participated in 34 regional conferences and round-ups throughout the United States and Canada, and in addition one Staff Member attended the Wiesbaden Round-Up in Germany. Another participated in Intergroup meetings in Mexico.

Staff Members also welcomed more than 1,000 visitors to G.S.O., from foreign countries as well as from the U.S. and Canada.

Staff Members convene weekly to report on trips, trends in correspondence, and to evaluate needs. We are always hoping to encourage more direct communication with the groups, for the more A.A.'s we correspond with, the more members will have shared in our Traditions and Service Concepts, the guides used by all Staff Members in all correspondence, and the guardians of our A.A. way of life.

—Eve M., G.S.O. Staff
Staff Coordinator

CONFERENCE 'VOICE OF A.A.'

When the first full Conference met in 1952, there were 75 Delegates, representing 4,000 groups in the United States and Canada. In contrast, 1968 brings together 89 Delegates as the voice of the 9,895 groups in North America.

The "Third Legacy Manual" says that "The General Service Conference is just the practical means by which A.A.'s group conscience can speak and put its desires for world service into operation. It is the voice of A.A. and the permanent guarantee that our world services shall continue to function under all conditions."

All Conference members, area Committee Members and G.S.R.'s, are encouraged to submit suggestions for the Conference agenda and any questions they would like brought up for discussion. The broadest base possible is sought for interest and participation. Agenda planning starts with the Agenda-Admissions Committee. The Conference Secretary is in touch with these Committee Members during the year and all subjects for the agenda are reported by her to the Trustees' Policy Committee in October. A preliminary agenda is prepared and presented to the Trustees'

Policy Committee and the General Service Board in January of each year.

The Conference is not just a six-day annual meeting — although that is the focal point. Conference activities in the area are a growing and vital part. At the present time, there are 1,219 area Committee Members, and the Secretary is in touch with each one of them as they are elected and put on our mailing list.

Through minutes of area committee meetings, assemblies and district meetings, we are hearing more and more about the service activities in all areas. By and large, General Service Committees appear to be expanding their activities and taking a more active part in helping to provide local services.

Much thought is being given, for instance, to the expense of a Delegate, not only during the Conference, but throughout the year, and many committees are assuming a greater portion of travel expenses for the Delegates and Committee Chairmen.

—Midge M., G.S.O. Staff
Conference Secretary

SEAMEN CARRY MESSAGE

The 1968 *Directory* lists 318 of these wonderful members who carry the message of A.A. in so many parts of the world. To help them do this, each receives a copy of the *World Directory*. They are often helpful to G.S.O. in providing up-to-date information about groups overseas. They receive a copy of the *Round Robin*, a newsletter which goes out to each of them every two months. In the months that they do not receive the *Robin*, they are, of course, receiving *Box 4-5-9*. Their interest helps, in many instances, to provide our groups overseas with literature. Recently, for example, we received a large order for Spanish pamphlets from one of the Internationalists for the group in Barcelona, and they often order literature and pick it up at the office for hand delivery.

From the response of the groups who have received visits from these members, we know how much help they are giving, and of course, it's a two-way street, as so many who are far from their own home group find the going tough when they reach port if an A.A. group or member is not available.

The main part of this service is correspondence. Lots of the members depend solely on G.S.O. for A.A. contact when no group is available in their overseas port of call, and they enjoy sharing A.A. experience through the *Round Robin* and with each other through our listings of home addresses, current ships, and shipping lines. Sometimes a group springs up on shipboard when two or more A.A.'s find themselves sailing together.

The Ham Radio Group is going great guns, and all those who are in it find it very helpful.

—Ann M., G.S.O. Staff
Internationalists

'A TIME FOR DECISION'

Delegates also viewed "A Time For Decision." The film depicts events in the life of an alcoholic and tells about the help offered to him and his family by various organizations, including A.A. Delegates voted to have this film made available to members on a rental basis.

Nearly 1,500 'Inside' Groups

Report

There are today approximately 830 prison groups with a membership of about 30,000 and 650 hospital groups with a membership of about 16,000.

Our services here involve correspondence (the bulk with prison groups) with the group secretaries, sponsors (G.S.R.'s in some instances), inside and out, A.A. and non, of many of these groups, with the 85 Institutional Committees that work with these "inside groups," and with many institutional officials and many non-A.A.'s who are interested in rehabilitation. (Twenty-three states do not have Institutional Committees.) Some of these function independently, others within the framework of the General Service Committee. The first issue of a new *Institutions Bulletin*, approved by the Institutions Committee of the Conference, has gone out, and it received such a good response that it is now our plan to produce three issues yearly, one in January, one in May, and one in September.

It goes without saying that in the areas where a well-organized committee is functioning, inside groups flourish and grow. In almost every letter that we receive from a hospital or prison group there is some mention of the help or lack of help that the group is getting from A.A.'s on the outside.

Problems connected with service to these institutional groups seem to be continuing ones, namely, how to get literature to them after the initial complimentary supply is exhausted. This is not a problem where there are Institutional Committees or others outside who spark the interest of nearby local groups. Sometimes a fund is set up, such as the "Buck-a-Month" in widespread use in California, or a special institutions fund used for the purpose of supplying literature needs.

—Ann M., G.S.O. Staff
Institutions

LONERS STAY SOBER THROUGH CORRESPONDENCE

A Lone member by definition is one who, by reason of geography or physical disabilities, is unable to attend meetings. There are presently 167 Lone members registered in the United States and Canada and 300 in overseas areas.

Putting first things first, our first effort is to help the Lone member maintain sobriety through correspondence with G.S.O. and with the help of A.A. literature. In addition, we have a long listing of Loner Sponsors. These are A.A. members who enjoy sharing through correspondence, and they maintain more frequent correspondence with Loners than is possible from the General Service Office.

However, each Loner receives material based on the shared experience of other Loners. They also receive a *Loners Meeting* which is mailed on alternate months, with Box 4-5-9.

Loners are encouraged to make every effort to "carry the message" in their communities. The fact that they succeed is

evidenced by the many flourishing groups today which have resulted from the efforts of one Lone member.

Correspondence from Loners is a source of inspiration. You can't beat letters like the following one from Viet Nam: "I want to pass on the language of the heart to those who still suffer from this illness and disease. My heart has been so filled with gratitude for what A.A. has done and is doing for me each day. This is such a small part that I can give back. Every day is a miracle for me, even though I am in a combat zone. I've been sober one day at a time since the 18th of June, 1964, and this blessing, the light of life, must be given away, and I can only be a messenger of God's will and try to do the best I can with His help and the help of all A.A.'s."

—Eve M., G.S.O. Staff
Lone Members

INSTITUTIONS COMMITTEE

Conference Action

The Institutions Committee of the General Service Conference made the following recommendations:

1. That Institutional Committees be encouraged to use a P.O. Box address so that referrals can be made without using an individual's name and address.
2. That A.A. groups in correctional facilities and hospitals adhere to A.A.'s 5th Tradition, on primary purpose of carrying the message to the alcoholic. That anyone with problems other than alcohol be made welcome at inside open meetings, but not participate in group activities.
3. That the present use of the *World Directory* be continued in order to provide immediate A.A. sponsorship for new members leaving an institution.
4. That members be reminded that A.A. offers sobriety and does not provide housing, food, clothes, jobs, money, or other welfare or social services when carrying the message inside the walls.
5. That G.S.O. make a survey of the duties performed by local Institutional Committee chairmen.
6. Elected Bob H., New Mexico, Chairman.

Ask-It-Basket

- Q. Is there anything wrong with an A.A. group making a cash donation to a hospital building fund and having the group's name listed on the building memorial plaque?
- A. It is best not to use the group name or to imply group endorsement.

G.S.B. Explores New Concepts, Techniques

Inside A.A.

Report

The year just past has been an exciting one for your General Service Board. For one thing, there has been an "infusion" of new blood on the Board itself. Since we last met, in April of 1967, we have welcomed no less than six new members: five Regional Trustees and one General Service Trustee. During this year, too, we took aboard a new Manager of our General Service Office.

Since A.A. casts such a long shadow over the whole field of alcoholism, it is inevitable that the vastly increased activity all around us should be reflected in our A.A. thinking. Thus new concepts, new approaches, new techniques are being explored by your General Service Board, and it is about several of these new concepts that I would like to speak now. Later this week you will hear more about these proposals. But now I want to mention them only to illustrate the challenges and opportunities that lie in our immediate future. Do not misunderstand me, please. When I speak of new concepts, I do *not* mean changes in our A.A. way of life, or in our program, or in our Traditions. I refer only to new concepts of *service*; to new and better ways of bringing our message to the sick alcoholic who still suffers.

But to continue — the 28th International Congress on Alcohol and Alcoholism will be held this coming September in Washington, D.C. The opportunity which it presents to us in A.A. is a unique one. To this meeting will come delegates from all over the world; physicians, sociologists, educators, public health experts, and many other professional and governmental specialists — all vitally interested in alcoholism, many of them knowing little about A.A. Our Society will be discussed in papers to be read, as well as at the special booth which we will have in the exhibit area. In addition we plan to reserve a hospitality suite where we can further explain A.A. to interested delegates.

Problems of Mutual Concern

A second new concept, which has been discussed at length by your Board, is that of a *world service meeting*, somewhat similar to this North American Conference we are attending today. If you approve this plan, your delegates will sit down with delegates from a dozen other countries and areas to discuss problems of mutual concern and to share experience on a worldwide basis.

Another idea to which your Board has devoted considerable thought relates to our lack of information about our own members. We know how many groups we have, and we have a pretty good idea of how many individual A.A.'s there are, but we know very little about their sobriety patterns. That is, how long it took them to achieve sobriety after they first contacted A.A., how many have had "slips," and so on. We have done a "pilot" survey, and the results are most encouraging. If you approve when this plan is presented for your consideration on Friday morning, we could then proceed with the survey itself. The amount of information which such a study could yield, and its value to us, is almost incalculable.

Let me give you one final example of the sort of problem — and the type of challenge — with which your Board has been concerned during the past year. As many of you know, the Supreme Court of the U.S. is expected to hand down a decision confirming that alcoholics are sick people, and that a man cannot be arrested simply because he is drunk.

The effects of this decision will be radical and far-reaching, no one can doubt. You will hear later what your Trustees' Public Information Committee has planned in order to take advantage of the challenge this decision will present; for now, suffice to say that advantage *can* and will be taken of this opportunity.

—John L. Norris, M.D., Chairman,
General Service Board.

CONFERENCE TRUSTEES COMMITTEE

Conference Action

The Conference Committee on Trustees took the following actions:

1. Reviewed the Composition, Scope and Procedure and History of the Committee and recommended that the electoral procedures for Regional Trustees be added to the Committee procedures.
2. Recommended that the possibility of electing one Trustee candidate from each Conference area, rather than one from each state or province, be studied and explored.
3. Recommended that the following candidates be presented for election as Trustees of the General Service Board:

Travis Dancey, M.D.	Andy A.
Vincent Dole, M.D.	Eric B.
Austin McCormick	Tom B.
Robert W. Morse	Rollie D.
Hon. John Murtagh	Charles (Edw.) L., Jr.
John L. Norris, M.D.	Bayard P., Jr.
Archibald B. Roosevelt	Katharine P.
Bernard B. Smith	Maurice R., Jr.
Harrison Trice, Ph.D.	Frank R.
	Ruth W.
	Don F.
4. Recommended that the following be elected as Officers of the General Service Board at its annual meeting, following the Conference in April:

Chairman: John L. Norris, M.D.
First Vice-Chairman: Bernard B. Smith
Second Vice-Chairman: Charles (Edw.) L., Jr.
Treasurer: Robert W. Morse
Secretary: Ruth W.

5. Recommended the name of Robert P. for election at the July Meeting of the General Service Board as an A.A. General Service Trustee.
6. Recommended that the revised electoral procedures for A.A. Regional Trustees be adopted by the General Service Conference and utilized in future elections.
7. Recommended that consideration be given to the possibility of using these electoral procedures in all A.A. elections.
8. Recommended that in describing the qualifications of the A.A. Trustee, emphasis be placed on the fact that the Trustee represents the entire Fellowship of A.A. and not a geographical area.
9. Elected, Warren S., Southern Coastal California, Chairman.

Language No Barrier to A.A.

International

Report

Barriers of language, culture, and great distance have not seriously interfered with extending the hand of A.A. to alcoholics — nearly 40,000 of them

in more than 1700 groups in 34 non-English-speaking countries. The message may have come first from a serviceman, a merchant seaman, a book, magazine, or newspaper article, but the miracle of recovery was the same no matter where it took place or what its source.

Our purpose in the Overseas service is to share experience, offer encouragement and support, and provide available assistance to the new member or group. We try to fulfill the two most important responsibilities of a parent: first, to help the youngster to walk and second, to help him walk *away*. The foreign A.A. quickly learns to walk — and run — and in general behave like his A.A. brothers everywhere — by way of the Twelve Suggested Steps. Learning to walk *away* comes harder, though the Twelve Traditions, we believe, provide a sure way.

It is easy for us, who have experienced all the blessings and few of the agonies of A.A.'s growing pains of twenty years ago, to analyze the overseas problems and predict their unfortunate results unless the Traditions are applied to the letter of the law. A.A. is *one* thing, all the time, everywhere. To the extent that A.A. unity is weak, so is the ability to fulfill A.A.'s primary purpose of "carrying the message." A.A. growth overseas indicates that the primary purpose is not being seriously impeded by lack of unity. Indeed, we have our hands full in trying to match service to the steadily mounting growth of A.A. overseas.

To this end, some time ago, we established the policy of encouraging General Service Boards as soon as a natural leadership begins to emerge, and the groups can accept this responsibility. A great deal of our time at G.S.O. is spent in working with these young boards and in sharing experience with them about establishing local services. At present, in non-English-speaking areas, there are Literature Distribution Centers, Publishing Companies, or General Service Boards in varying stages of development in Belgium, Holland, France, Germany, Finland, Norway, Colombia, and Honduras. Mexico and El Salvador have Literature Distribution Centers and are working toward the development of General Service Boards.

—Cora Louise B., G.S.O. Staff
International (non-English-speaking)

PROVIDING GUIDES FOR SERVICES

In addition to the exchange of correspondence with the Fellowship overseas, G.S.O. provides the following specific guides for service:

1. Box 4-5-9, a bulletin mailed to all overseas English-speaking groups.
2. A.A. Guidelines, compiled from the experience of A.A. members in the various service areas.
3. Complimentary supply of literature and the *World Directory* to new groups in areas where there is no General Service Officer or Literature Distribution Center in existence.

A.A. growth overseas has been stimulating and exciting. Here are a few highlights:

In March 1968, A.A. celebrated its 21st Anniversary in Great Britain. The A.A. Publishing Co. established by the Australian Service Conference started to accept literature orders in Sydney,

New South Wales, on January 31, 1968. A.A. in India has grown over the past year from 12 to 20 groups. In Bombay alone there are 9 groups, and they have revitalized an Intergrupp Committee to help serve them.

TRANSLATIONS SERVICE: the purpose of this service is to help A.A. groups and General Service Offices overseas to obtain translations faithful to original A.A. General Service Conference-approved literature. We are currently working with groups in such countries as Brazil, Japan and Germany, to name just a few. The following guide is used for evaluating translations:

1. Is it faithful to the spirit as well as to the words of the original text?
2. Is it well written and does it conform to acceptable standards of grammar and vocabulary?
3. Is it interesting and alive, or just a dry, literal translation?

There are about 15,000 members in more than 1,000 English-speaking groups outside the North American continent.

—Beth K., G.S.O. Staff
International (English-speaking)

REPORT FROM FINLAND

There are about 3,000 A.A. members in Finland. They meet in 149 groups in 64 locations. There are more than 30 groups in prisons and hospitals. The Big Book in the Finnish language is sold out and a second edition is now being prepared. The newest translation in Finnish is "The A.A. Group." Other pamphlets include "This is A.A.," "Young People in A.A." and "Alcoholism the Illness." An information bulletin, "Ratkaisuz" is issued six times a year and distributed to groups and individual members. Celebration of Finnish A.A.'s 20th anniversary took place on April 20 at Helsinki. Several prominent people attended as well as A.A. members from all parts of the country.

—Johan von T., Observer.

Ask-It-Basket

- Q. What is A.A.'s opinion when a group of Mohammedans, Buddhists or others recite prayers originating in their various faiths and call this gathering an A.A. meeting?
- A. The Twelve Suggested Steps mention "a Power greater than ourselves" and "God, as we understand Him." Any interpretation is left to the individual. Experience indicates that the A.A. program is flexible enough to be compatible with any religious belief — or none.
- Q. Is there any information going to the medical profession regarding the danger of "pills" to the alcoholic?
- A. The pamphlet, "Sedatives, Stimulants and the Alcoholic," written by A.A. doctors, is often given by individual members to their own physicians. Dr. Dancey, nonalcoholic Trustee, said that the average doctor could best be reached through articles on this problem in the medical journals.

Significance of the Printed Word

Literature

Presentation

Literature is of enormous significance to A.A. Through the written and printed word, we can make available to all the peoples of the earth the history of past experience from time immemorial, as well as the record of present thought and action, and the plans and aspirations of mankind for the future.

It is especially true in A.A. that the spoken word has warmth and persuasive power that only the most inspired written words can have. Yet the best expression is in words spoken with warmth and sincerity by a person who has full knowledge and understanding of the A.A. literature — one who knows what specific reading to recommend to the person he is trying to help, and who has in his hand or in his pocket, some book or pamphlet that will open the person's mind to the full richness and helpfulness of our literature.

—Austin MacCormick, *Chairman.*

CONFERENCE-APPROVED LITERATURE

The General Service Office recently conducted a poll about the literature distributed at A.A. meetings. You were asked about both (1) Conference-approved literature — the publications distributed throughout the world by G.S.O. — and (2) what I shall call "the Other literature."

From your replies G.S.O. concludes that about 70 percent of the respondent groups use some Other literature in addition to G.S.O. literature. Of that Other literature, some groups use only one pamphlet — frequently the local meeting list or directory. Others use as many as seven books and 32 pamphlets, none of them the G.S.O. publications we are all familiar with — the ones displayed in the back of this room just as they are in most A.A. meeting rooms. (Why always the *back*? Why not the *front*? I know one group that doubled its rate of literature distribution by moving the literature display to the front of the room, from the back.)

The four most popular Other pieces in 1968 are the same four that headed the list in a 1966 survey on the same subject. They are:

24 Hours A Dayused by 23% of the responding groups;
The Little Red Book . . .used by 12% of the responding groups;
"Who, Me?"used by 6% of the responding groups;
Stools and Bottles.used by 6%.

There seems to be three main kinds of this Other literature.

1. First, there is local A.A. literature published by local A.A.'s. The local meeting directory is a good example, and surely we are all glad to find these freely available, especially if they list ALL the local A.A. facilities and meetings in the community, not just an exclusive few.
2. The second kind of Other literature is material about alcoholism published not by A.A. but by some other agencies interested in alcoholism, such as the National Council on Alcoholism, or the Al-Anon Family Groups, or some religious organization, or tax-supported alcoholism program.

3. The third kind of Other literature is the inspirational or devotional type with no mention whatsoever of either A.A. or alcoholism.

—Barry L., *Literature Committee.*

LITERATURE IN MANY LANGUAGES

The effect of translated literature as a means of carrying the message, and on the growth and development of A.A. in countries where the language is other than English, can best be realized by the fact that in 1946 the only literature available was that in the English language, and there were no groups or members other than those in Canada, England, Australia, United States and one lone member in Mexico. Today, in 1968, we have literature in 18 different languages and members and groups in 90 countries (including 58 non-English-speaking), surely an amazing growth over a period of some twenty years.

All of this brought to a realization the dream Bill had in 1949, when for the first time he heard the Lord's Prayer and the Twelve Steps read in French and realized that the message of A.A. could and would eventually transcend all barriers of language, race and creed.

The growth and development of A.A. through translations of our literature is part of the romance and history of A.A. It all began with the translation of the Twelve Steps, and was carried on to what we have today, through what Bill calls the "Language of the Heart."

It is our first responsibility and the *raison d'être* of our existence as a Fellowship to carry the message. Now that we are capable of doing it in many languages, there should be no need ever again for anyone, anywhere, to be unable to find the A.A. message in a language that he can understand.

—Rollie D., *Trustee, Eastern Canada.*

REACHING PROFESSIONALS

There is in my area an employer, who through TV, radio, and A.A. literature has become a strong advocate of our Fellowship. He informs us that his A.A. employees, about 10 percent of his personnel, are the most trusted and conscientious of all.

There is also the minister of our group's church, who had read practically all of our literature, and gets the Grapevine regularly. He has sent many a sick alcoholic to our Fellowship for help, and the majority of these people are living examples for everyone—including his own church members. He also stated that he has never seen an expression of love and compassion toward our fellowman, as is being shown every day in the A.A. Fellowship.

My personal physician keeps the Grapevine in a very prominent place in his reception room. On each of my regular monthly check-up visits with him, he fires questions at me for about an hour, while the rest of his patients wait. He was quite concerned one time, when he said that one of the Grapevines had disappeared from his office. I informed him that perhaps the person who pilfered it needs help. He smiled and said, "Maybe you're right—and I hope he calls A.A.!"

Through our P.I.C., we have been able to reach many of the professional people who are slowly but surely becoming aware of the fact that the A.A. way is by far the best way to help the suffering alcoholic!

—Andy P., *Southeast Michigan.*

Literature Preserves Unity

Presentation

Literature plays a very important part in our Conference theme of unity. Literature reaches the alcoholic and the non-alcoholic. It carries the message. Literature is a tool and a visual aid used by the clergyman, social worker, educator, agency and common man. Language has no barrier since the message is presented in any language where there is a printed symbol.

Groups can increase the usage of literature by skillfully displaying it in meeting places. Reference to literature as we speak is a means of dramatizing the significance of literature. In so doing we are setting the stage for greater understanding and unity.

Much time and thought should be given to conference displays. A pamphlet which I've found to be most helpful when talking to groups concerning the structure of Fellowship is the "A.A. Group." But let us not forget "What Happened to Joe?" This piece of literature reaches people in all walks of life—the reader and the non-reader, the young and the old. Literature brings us closer to the realization of unity.

—Louis R., Eastern Pennsylvania.

RECOVERY THROUGH READING

We all are aware of the big part that our A.A. literature has meant in the recovery of thousands of alcoholics all over the world. In April of 1939 the Big Book appeared. Before its publication, four hundred mimeographed copies were circulated amongst A.A.'s and non's to get their suggestions and corrections. One of these copies reached a nonalcoholic ex-wife of a member sober in A.A. through reading it. She, in turn, took the book to the West Coast where she placed it in the hands of the city's Probation Department and all of a sudden A.A. was growing rapidly in Los Angeles. From then on, it spread like wild fire through California and the "Big Book" effected thousands of recoveries.

There were a thousand alcoholics sitting at a meeting in Los Angeles at which Bill and Lois were present in 1943. Bill concluded, "In the future, no alcoholic messenger in the flesh might be needed at all."

Marty M., the first woman in A.A. who was able to maintain her sobriety, came into A.A. through a reading of the Big Book

Ask-It-Basket

Q. Why can't we have a 24-Hour book, printed by G.S.O.?

A. The "Twenty-four Hours a Day" book was offered to A.A.W.S. some years ago. The Conference then felt it was too spiritually or religiously oriented. A.A.W.S. would be reluctant to put out a similar book, since it has no wish to compete with this book. "The A.A. Way of Life" seems to serve the same need.

that she had been given by our wonderful nonalcoholic friend, Dr. Tiebout, in a sanitorium for alcoholics. Since then women in A.A. have multiplied to the extent that in the big cities, at least, about fifty percent of the members are women.

That over a million and a half pamphlets were distributed in 1967 is a matter for rejoicing, because an A.A. pamphlet in the doctor's office, lying on a table in the clinic waiting room, in the judge's chamber, distributed at medical or other professional conventions, sent directly to the alcoholic or to a friend or relative, in other words wherever a person concerned with alcoholism can read it, could mean recovery to one more alcoholic and an addition to our ever-growing family of A.A. worldwide.

—Pete S., Utah.

LITERATURE DISTRIBUTED - 1967

BOOKS

Alcoholics Anonymous	38,446
Twelve Steps & Twelve Traditions (Reg. Edition)	13,394
Twelve Steps & Twelve Traditions (Gift Edition)	3,579
Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age	4,205
30th Anniversary Book - A.A./30	778
Alcoholics Anonymous - Spanish Edition	2,682
A.A. Way of Life (New)	21,677
Total	84,761

PAMPHLETS

The A.A. Group	26,093
This is A.A.	135,490
44 Questions & Answers	107,650
Is A.A. For You?	168,329
Young People in A.A.	49,917
A.A. for the Woman	51,480
A.A. Traditions	22,494
Questions & Answers on Sponsorship	37,108
Alcoholism the Illness	67,001
The Alcoholic Husband	69,417
The Alcoholic Wife	45,840
A.A. and the Alcoholic Employee	23,505
A.A. and the Medical Profession	25,805
Sedatives, Stimulants & The Alcoholic	67,459
The Jack Alexander Article About A.A.	41,945
The Fortune Story About A.A.	24,797
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	47,336
Inside A.A.	29,447
A Clergyman Asks About A.A.	27,544
Fellowship of A.A.	53,743
Memo to an Inmate	22,577
A.A. in Prisons	9,909
G.S.R. Folder	21,040
A.A. in Hospitals	17,809
A.A. in your Community	116,300
What Happened to Joe (New)	143,153
Foreign Translations	64,960
The Third Legacy Manual & 12 Concepts	2,764
Total	1,520,930

MISCELLANEOUS

Tapes of A.A. Talks	342
Wallet Cards - 2 Fold	227,696
Wallet Cards - "I am Responsible"	36,560
Parchment Scrolls	1,784
How It Works	70,506
Newcomer Meeting Kit (New)	1,282
Group Handbook (New)	904

A.A. Literature Being Revised

Literature

Report

During the past year the Literature Committee of the General Service Board, in cooperation with the Conference Literature Committee, continued to work

on revisions of the following pieces:

- 1) "A.A. for the Woman," which with entirely new stories will soon be ready for distribution.
- 2) "Young People and A.A.," which also with new stories is in the final stages before printing,
- 3) "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship," the revision of which has been delayed until a substantial improvement on the present pamphlet is accomplished. Two revisions which have been attempted are good, but the committee felt that they were no better than the present text.

The committee is also working on a cartoon pamphlet for women similar to "What Happened to Joe." This pamphlet is now in the final stages of completion and should be in distribution very soon, after approval by the Conference Literature Committee. Institutional Committees, Intergroups, and sponsors of institutional women's groups have been consulted concerning its preparation.

A draft of a pamphlet illustrative of the Traditions, with drawings similar to those that have appeared in the A.A. Grapevine, but with many changes and added text, is being worked on and will be submitted to the Conference Literature Committee for its consideration when it is ready.

The suggestion that a pamphlet be prepared for Armed Services personnel is being explored and, if it is considered feasible, work will be started on it.

Following the suggestion of a pamphlet for A.A. members who may be experiencing difficulties (although not drinking) after a long period of sobriety in A.A., stories are being collected to see if this material should be valuable in helping these members.

—Austin MacCormick, Chairman
G.S.B. Literature Committee.

Ask-It-Basket

- Q. How many copies of the Big Book have been published? Sold since 1939?
- A. As of 3/31/68 — 722,190 published; 667,600 distributed.
- Q. What is the difference between "Character Defects" and "Shortcomings"?
- A. A Staff Member said that she asked this question of Bill some years ago. Quite simply, he said he didn't want to use the same word twice. He intended the two terms to mean the same thing.

CONFERENCE LITERATURE COMMITTEE

Conference Action

The Conference Literature Committee approved the G.S.O. report of work in progress on the revisions of old and the preparation of new pamphlets and recommended:

1. That Conference-approved literature and G.S.O. Guidelines be displayed and distributed at assembly meetings.
2. That brief mimeograph service material (not guideline format) be prepared to provide a listing of source material from Conference-approved literature as an aid to closed-meeting discussion.
3. That the pamphlet, "The A.A. Group," be brought to the attention of new group officers as they rotate.
4. That a yearly questionnaire be sent to a sampling of A.A. groups to determine literature needs.
5. Elected Toy E., Southern Indiana, Chairman.

AGENDA-ADMISSIONS COMMITTEE

Conference Action

The Agenda-Admissions Committee of the Conference took the following actions:

1. Recommended that a study of Admissions procedures be conducted and that the Agenda-Admissions Committee meet in the fall of 1968, in New York, after a preliminary exploration through correspondence.
2. Recommended unanimously that Quebec be granted a third bilingual Delegate to be elected as a member of Panel 19. The third Delegate is to be elected from a newly designated Conference area to be called the Northeast area of Quebec.
3. Suggested subjects for the 1969 General Service Conference:
 - a. What is being done and what more can be done to utilize TV and radio as a means of "carrying the message"?
 - b. What problems have come up in your areas as a result of the Supreme Court Decision?
 - c. Where does cooperation stop and affiliation begin?
4. Recommended that Delegates be informed of important issues so they can read prepared material and perhaps discuss before voting.
5. Elected Fernand I., Quebec, Chairman.

Sharing in Print

Grapevine

Report

All A.A. Conference-approved literature — and the Grapevine, as the only Conference-approved periodical, is no exception — serves the cause of A.A. unity. If we were confined to word of mouth, and there were no A.A. writings of any kind — no Big Book, no pamphlets, no Grapevine — it would be difficult and probably impossible to maintain the A.A. message in anything like its original form. In the brief period, historically speaking, that A.A. has existed — a mere 33 years — a message entirely dependent on oral means of transmission would have been altered beyond recognition, and would have been subject to personal variations as numerous as there are A.A. members.

Does anyone believe that A.A. would today be functioning in more than ninety countries — in each of which virtually the same program is offered to the incoming alcoholic despite tremendous diversity of language, if there had never been any Big Book, and there existed no other printed matter describing A.A. and relating the experiences of individual members?

The Grapevine goes each month to more than 35 different nations. Its articles are read by English-speaking A.A.'s who, in turn, are in communication with others in A.A. in these nations, and sharing experience with them in the language of the place. Grapevine articles are translated and reprinted in A.A. publications around the world. And the Grapevine receives, and prints, letters from around the world — from Colombia to Karachi.

Over and over again, the pages of the Grapevine contain inspiring evidence of two important truths: (1) that human beings caught in the web of compulsive drinking are much alike whatever their color, creed, or native tongue, and (2) that the appeal to a Higher Power for help, through A.A., in stopping drinking and changing one's life is effective wherever men and women will really undertake the Twelve Steps program in fellowship with others who suffer from the same disability.

A Responsible Concern

When one alcoholic, himself sober and beginning recovery, reaches out to another to help him aboard the A.A. life raft, the great first principle of A.A. always applies: there can be no recovery for any of us, unless we are willing to share our energies and prayers with others. This is no mere pious platitude set down to make us look good. It's a statement of how A.A. works — literally. Without sharing of our experience, there would be no talks at meetings, open or closed. Without sharing of work and some money, there would be no meeting rooms, no coffee and cake. Without sharing of love, of responsible concern for fellow alcoholics, there would be no twelfth stepping, and no international linkage of A.A. telephones and publications.

The Grapevine is a "sharing" in print. Every article, every drawing, photo, or cartoon, is someone's hard work. Some A.A. or friend of A.A. (and we have many, not themselves in A.A. who have worked for A.A.) has let his concern for alcoholics prompt him to the lonely work of writing and drawing, so that thousands upon thousands of other A.A.'s may be lifted up, as they read.

The essence of the Grapevine is this: An alcoholic who lives in Vancouver, B.C., who is a lawyer in his middle years, sober twelve years, can write of his life, before and after A.A., for the Grapevine. Then, an alcoholic in South Africa, a factory worker in his twenties, sober a few months, and a housewife in Bris-

bane, mother of four, sober a year, can both find help in living the sober day by the example of the distant Canadian.

The Grapevine is committed to the best possible blend of editorial balance and excitement, and the editorial staff is responsible for presenting different personal opinions within the framework of the A.A. program as outlined in the Big Book and other basic A.A. writings. The Grapevine's goal is the maximum diversity of expression within the limits set out by the First Tradition: "Our common welfare should come first: personal recovery depends on A.A. unity."

—Tom W., Editor

CIRCULATION NEARS 50,000

Report

The past year has been another good one for the Grapevine. Circulation (as of April, 1968) is at an all-time high of nearly 50,000.

The past year has been a good one financially, too. Several years ago the Grapevine was able to set aside sufficient money to cover "unearned income" and begin building a modest reserve against future emergencies. (Unearned income is that portion of subscription funds the Grapevine has received for which the Grapevine owes subscribers a certain number of future issues.) The Grapevine's financial report for 1967 appears elsewhere in this publication.

The 1968 Grapevine calendar was a sell-out at \$1.25 (\$1.00 to groups). Ten thousand copies were sold mostly to individuals, although a number of groups bought large quantities. The success of the calendar encouraged the Grapevine Board and Staff to continue the project. A 1969 calendar is in preparation.

The "Best of Bill" continued in great demand after the Grapevine decided not to reprint (20,000 copies of the five pamphlet packet had been sold), so that it has become necessary to order still another reprint of 10,000 and continue to offer the packet for sale.

Sales of the two-color Slogans, Serenity Prayer, magazine binders, and Preamble cards continue at a satisfactory rate in spite of the fact that increased mailing, printing, and handling costs have forced price rises on most items.

—Tom W., Editor

DIFFERING OPINIONS IN GV?

Interview Time

How far do you think the Grapevine should go in publishing articles which set forth individual differences of opinion on the A.A. program?

Delegates' opinions on this question were quite varied, ranging from "controversy hurts no one," to the opposite extreme. The consensus, however, seemed to be that there is nothing wrong with discussing individual points of view, as long as they are in good taste and don't infringe on the Steps and Traditions of A.A.

GRAPEVINE CIRCULATION 4-1-68

UNITED STATES

Alabama	389
Alaska	106
Arizona	360
Arkansas	379
California	5,089
Colorado	435
Connecticut	860
Delaware	171
Washington, D.C.	254
Florida	1,423
Georgia	653
Hawaii	79
Idaho	152
Illinois	1,708
Indiana	695
Iowa	566
Kansas	638
Kentucky	497
Louisiana	466
Maine	320
Maryland	928
Massachusetts	2,266
Michigan	1,759
Minnesota	1,149
Mississippi	275
Missouri	805
Montana	236
Nebraska	313
Nevada	160
New Hampshire	199
New Jersey	1,805
New Mexico	266
New York	4,331
North Carolina	896
North Dakota	207
Ohio	2,074
Oklahoma	729
Oregon	429
Pennsylvania	1,453
Rhode Island	158
South Carolina	404
South Dakota	324
Tennessee	401
Texas	2,133
Utah	198
Vermont	215
Virginia	797
Washington	887
West Virginia	266
Wisconsin	842
Wyoming	95
Total	42,240

CANADA

Alberta	489
British Columbia	856
Manitoba	625
New Brunswick	202
Newfoundland	67
Northwest Territory	12
Nova Scotia	296
Ontario	2,538
Prince Edward Island	112
Quebec	429
Saskatchewan	468
Yukon	11
Total	6,105

United States Possessions	103
All Foreign	997

Grapevine

GRAPEVINE COMMITTEE

Conference Action

The Grapevine Committee of the General Service Conference took the following actions:

1. Recommended that the Grapevine, being the voice of individual A.A. members, continue to publish the opinion of A.A. members, provided, however, that the Grapevine does not add its editorial endorsement to articles, and that it state that the opinions expressed therein are not necessarily those of the Grapevine.
2. That encouragement be given to the Grapevine Group Sponsorship program whereby groups are encouraged to send a new subscription each month to doctors, ministers and others interested in alcoholism, as well as institutions or other agencies selected by the group as a joint Twelfth Step venture.
3. Elected Ralph L., Oregon, Chairman.

Ask-It-Basket

Q. Can we establish a Canadian bank deposit for G.S.O. contributions? Group secretaries have trouble in transposing Canadian contributions into U.S. money differences.

A. Most Canadian groups send contributions in Canadian dollars and we convert into U.S. dollars. The WORLD DIRECTORY (Canadian section) carries a footnote on each page, noting that Canadian dollars have been discounted 8% and the contributions are listed in the Directory in U.S. money.

Q. Could the Delegates, individually, or through the Committee Members, be responsible for the group listings?

A. Some of the Delegates have assumed this responsibility. G.S.O. would certainly be glad to know which Delegates could take responsibility for seeing to the mailing and returning of cards to G.S.O. prior to the deadline of the Directory.

Q. Is there some reason for not issuing a news item on our General Service Conference?

A. This Conference is a non-public, confidential meeting, from which newsmen are excluded. But, following the Conference an Annual Report to the Public is released, because it is believed the public has a right to know the state of A.A. and the results of the Conference deliberations.

Reaching the 'Hard-to-Reach'

Public
Information

Presentation

Hard-to-reach alcoholics seem to fall into three categories — those on Skid Row, those in institutions, and those who are members of minorities. Let's look at the minorities first.

1. Most of the members of minorities are quite unreached by the newspapers, magazines and broadcasts which carry news about A.A. and alcoholism. Many of them are only semi-literate, and whatever reading, listening or viewing they do tends to be confined to either ethnic or sensational media.
2. Many of them have different interests and, therefore, do not respond to the same appeals that you and I respond to. Their appetites, their living patterns are too different from yours and mine.
3. They tend to split into two camps — those who deal with the majority and those who do not. Generally these camps dislike and mistrust one another. A.A. reaches only the former and smaller group — those who deal with the majority — thus leaving the latter group untouched. As evidence of this, we have found that in one community of 800,000 Negroes and Puerto Ricans, there are only 150 active members of A.A., and the membership is now growing.

For these reasons, if we are responsible... for trying to carry the message and for seeing that the hand of A.A. is always there, it would seem that we must take some initiative in devising ways of telling these suffering alcoholics: What A.A. is, Where it is, and How to get help.

Finally let me touch on the opportunity that is coming up to reach many of the Skid Row types -- as a result of the anticipated Supreme Court decision. You have already received a letter from us outlining the dangers and opportunities as we see them. When the decision is handed down, all groups will receive a kit containing suggested material for communicating with local agencies and local media. At General Service, we will provide material to all national news, trade and professional publications.

—Bayard P., General Service Trustee.

LOCAL P.I.C.'s ACTIVE

Questions can sometimes be just as useful and as hope-inspiring as answers. In the reports that local Public Information Committees have sent in to this committee, there have been plenty of excellent answers — proven ways to make A.A.'s presence known in everybody's home town. But these reports ask questions, too, and the questions tell us that local P.I.C.'s are not content with the hard work they are already doing. They want to accomplish more. Their questions mean growth — an eagerness to learn from other committees' experience.

"Yes, we hold public meetings regularly," they say. "But how can we get a better turn-out?"

"Yes, we send information about A.A. to our newspapers and our radio and TV stations. But what's the best way to approach them, so they'll be more likely to put these facts into print and on the air?"

"We've written letters to the heads of local business firms, pointing out how A.A. can help with alcoholic employees. We've

enclosed the right pamphlets. But isn't there some way we can improve our chance of getting through to the man or woman whose drinking is beginning to interfere with the job?"

There is a feeling of urgency about these questions. Jobs and health and lives are at stake. But there is also a feeling of confidence that the answers will be found. Somewhere, each P.I. Committee seems to believe, there must be another committee that has solved the problem.

So it is increasingly recognized that an important part of P.I. activity should be to keep communication lines open *within* the Fellowship, too. —Janet G., Public Information Committee.

EXPANDING ACTIVITIES

Report

The expanded public information activities here at the General Service Office are designed to help us hold out the hand of A.A. to an increasing number of still suffering alcoholics.

We hope to achieve this in a number of ways. One of the most important and effective is through getting the A.A. story in print and on the air more often at both the local and national levels

To that end we try to be more aware of what newspapers, radio and television are doing, what materials they are using and what they are in need of. It is also important for us to let media know that we are available to provide information on A.A. structure, case histories and other material.

While we try to reach national media, it is just as important to reach local newspapers, radio and television with the A.A. story. In order to accomplish this, we are constantly exploring ways to help make local Public Information Committees more effective. One way we can do this is to act as a clearing house through which committees can share their experience with each other.

Another area in which we are trying to establish a firmer foothold is in business and industry. As you know, most alcoholics hold down regular jobs. It is felt that we can reach them through employee magazines, industrial films and educational programs. Again it is a question of letting business, industry and labor know that we have the information about A.A. available if they want to make use of it.

We also would like to help establish better relations with other agencies working in the field of alcoholism, as well as with professionals, such as doctors, lawyers, and the clergy.

—Niles P., Public Information Committee.

Ask-It-Basket

Q. Should Delegates seek publicity regarding attendance at the General Service Conference?

A. This might provide good information about the Fellowship, providing, of course, the Delegate's anonymity was maintained.

P.I.C. Lets Public Know About A.A.

Public
Information

Report

The Trustees' Public Information Committee last year worked in many areas to carry out its objectives in line with the Conference-approved resolution regarding the "Responsibilities of the Movement for Keeping People Informed."

The first release on A.A.'s Convention, to take place in Florida, 1970, was sent in June to health agencies, church periodicals, H.E.W., N.C.A., and N.A.A.A.P., and their affiliates.

The pamphlet, "What Happened to Joe," was released to the media in August, 1967, and an article on A.A. and alcoholism appeared in the March issue of Resident Physician Magazine.

In addition, the story of Louis R. was released to 200 Negro dailies and weeklies throughout the U.S. A copy of Bill's new book, "The A.A. Way Of Life" was sent to approximately 100 religious and inspiration publications for review and comment.

The committee also provided information and literature to various other publications, radio, and TV stations.

In cooperation with other agencies, members of P.I.C. attended a number of meetings, and worked to solve problems arising in cooperation between A.A. and the various agencies in the field of alcoholism.

In line with these aims, "Cooperation But Not Affiliation" has been revised and Guidelines for Participation in Alcoholism Information Week were prepared and mailed to all Delegates and P.I.C.'s.

—Murray W., Chairman
Trustees' Public Information Committee

ANSWER 6,283 INQUIRIES

The Information Desk at the General Service Office received 6,283 mail inquiries during 1967. This breaks down to approximately thirty letters a day that need to be researched and answered. They come from students, teachers, nurses, social workers, libraries, families and friends, alcoholics, public health agencies, industry, clergymen, and state commissions on alcoholism who request general information on A.A. and alcoholism.

Our two professional exhibits were manned by General Service Delegates and/or local P.I. Committees at meetings and conventions all over the country, in the fields of education, welfare, medicine and social work, among others.

An ample quantity of the pamphlet "A.A. In Your Community" with the exhibits is supplied by G.S.O., as well as labels listing other available pamphlets. The completed labels are forwarded to G.S.O. and the requested pamphlets and/or information is mailed. A total of 667 labels was received and processed in 1967.

In addition, our table top "One-Way Display" was sent to a number of local and state professional gatherings in 1967.

There were 163 requests for additional literature received at G.S.O., from the showing of the "One-Way Display."

G.S.O. received 2,327 domestic clippings in 1967 indicating the continued cooperation of the press and excellent work of

local P.I.C.'s. The clippings revealed 26 anonymity breaks in 1967. The media, the Delegate in the area and the individual involved were sent letters and appropriate material on A.A.'s Tradition of anonymity.

Members of the Conference Committee are advised of all anonymity breaks. The clippings also revealed other breaches of A.A.'s Traditions, such as the naming of A.A. centers as recipients of funds from outside A.A., and news of clubs soliciting community funds.

The Staff Member on the Information Desk had the privilege of carrying the A.A. message to special members of the community by providing the proper information and appropriate literature.

—Waneta N., G.S.O. Staff
Information Services

CONFERENCE P.I. COMMITTEE

Conference Action

The Conference Committee on P.I. took the following actions:

1. Reviewed and approved the pamphlet "The Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous," with the minor changes, and it will now carry the seal.
2. Recommended that the showing of the full face of an A.A. member at the level of press, TV and films be considered a violation of the Anonymity Tradition, even though the name is withheld.
3. Approved "Suggestions for Improving A.A.'s Relations with the Medical Profession in the Community," and recommended that it be made available to all A.A. groups.
4. Reviewed and approved the statement on "Functions of Local Public Information Committees," with revisions.
5. Confirmed Tradition of self-support by agreeing that Telephone Meetings in which the Telephone Company makes its facilities available without charge are not within this Tradition.
6. Elected Mickey McM., Western Massachusetts, Chairman.

COOPERATION WITH COMMUNITY

Interview Time

Do local A.A. groups cooperate in community programs and rehabilitation projects?

Delegates provided a number of answers to this question, which indicated that cooperation ranged from very good to poor in various areas. Most noted that there has been substantial improvement over the years and that the groups in their areas are working to improve cooperation even further.

Reaffirm Anonymity Tradition

Conference Action

Following presentations by Delegates in which they discussed the pros and cons of anonymity, Delegates reaffirmed the principle of anonymity at the public level. They also noted that a full-face appearance on TV is an anonymity break even though the name is withheld.

Presentation

What does anonymity mean to A.A. members? Is it the most misunderstood of all A.A.'s Traditions? The Traditions concerned with anonymity are:

Our public relations policy is based on attraction rather than promotion; we need always maintain personal anonymity at the level of press, radio and films.

Anonymity is the spiritual foundation of all our Traditions, ever reminding us to place principles before personalities.

Therefore, in this presentation we shall speak only of anonymity at the level of press, radio, and films.

When a break in anonymity comes to the attention of G.S.O., here is the procedure we follow: 1. If at all possible, we contact the member involved, to hear his side of the story. 2. A friendly letter explaining our Tradition of anonymity is sent to the newspaper, radio or television station concerned. 3. The Delegate in the area is advised of the break and of the action taken.

—Waneta N., G.S.O. Staff

ANONYMITY REASSURES NEWCOMERS

Two reasons why we should preserve the Tradition of anonymity are:

1. Despite increasing knowledge about the disease of alcoholism, problem drinkers still hesitate to seek help in A.A. If they have reason to believe that their anonymity may not be protected. Therefore, anonymity at the public level is our assurance to newcomers that their membership in A.A. will not be disclosed, nor will they ever be expected or required to disclose it. It will be up to them to tell those they think should know.
2. More importantly, in the long run, perhaps, the principle of personal anonymity helps discourage drives for power, profit and prestige which could divert us from our primary purpose: *staying sober and helping other alcoholics achieve sobriety*. Thus, anonymity at the public level assures us that no individual A.A. member will be publicly acknowledged as a spokesman or leader. Within our Traditions, members do not claim nor are they given credit for their sobriety. Nor do they use their membership for personal gain or self-aggrandizement — to further their careers, promote their products or services, or to give weight to their arguments in public controversy.

As our Traditions remind us it is more than a denial of self-seeking, it is a constant and practical reminder that personal ambition has no place in A.A.

Any digression from our original motives for this Tradition could not be justified on any grounds, least of all that we must keep abreast of changing times, because to me I feel that the alcoholic of today is the same poor suffering alcoholic of yesterday.

—Peter W., Eastern Ontario.

AURA OF RESPECTABILITY

After reams of publicity, much time, effort and money spent in education by various agencies, and recognition by professional associations, the disease of alcoholism is out in the open. A more informed public today is not as devoid of empathy for the alcoholic as in 1938 or 1946. No longer does the fact that a person is the victim of the disease relegate him to the role of an outcast in today's society. The stigma of the past has been replaced by a certain aura of respectability.

The recovery record enjoyed by A.A. has been judged phenomenal. Its reputation is held in the highest regard by the medical profession, the clergy, labor and industry, governmental and law enforcement agencies. No longer is it possible for the unbecoming conduct or relapse of a few to bring discredit to the Fellowship as a whole.

Perhaps we should revert to the prescription of Luke who said: "No man when he hath lighted a candle, putteth it in a secret place, neither under a bushel, but on a candlestick, that they which come in may see the light."

One of the definitions given by Webster for "anonymous" is, "Lacking marked individuality or personality." Since, by no stretch of the imagination, does this describe a member of A.A., maybe we should change the meaning of A.A. from "Alcoholics Anonymous" to "Alcoholics Associated." —Max H., Arkansas.

ANONYMITY BREAKS HELP A.A.?

Years ago when a noted ball player broke his anonymity, the wonderful press reviews this man received did us much good.

When the Governor of the State of Iowa broke his anonymity, the only furor that it created was in A.A. The general public seemed to accept it very graciously. In fact, when the Governor's opponent tried to read some fault into the Governor's reasons, he suddenly discovered he had made the biggest mistake of his political life. The benefits to the alcoholic have been numerous in State and Federal Government interest. We now have a Federal program, designed to find the alcoholic, help him financially, medically and get him started in the right direction.

Now, take the case of the Municipal Judge in my town. He also broke his anonymity. Who do you suppose leads all of the other judges when it comes to election time? That's right, he does. He also started a court class for men and women who are arrested for intoxication — patterned much after A.A. It is not only a success, but has spread all over the United States.

I tell you these things only to make you think. Are we making a mistake? Perhaps somewhere between total anonymity and complete disregard of it, there may be an answer. Let's see if we can find a way.

—John G., Iowa.

Review of Electoral Procedures

Nominating

Report

During the past year, the Nominating Committee met quarterly, prior to the meetings of the General Service Board.

Some of the actions of the committee during the past year include:

1. Review of the electoral procedures for Regional Trustees at the suggestion of the Conference Committee on Trustees.
2. Review and revision of the material describing the qualifications for both Regional and General Service Trustees.
3. Reaffirmation of the position expressed at the 16th General Service Conference to the effect that an A.A. member professionally employed in the field of alcoholism should not be excluded from service on the General Service Board solely for that reason; but it is desirable that the Board and its Nominating Committee "maintain the guardianship of A.A. on a non-professional level."
4. Review of the resumes of the nine Trustee candidates from the West Central Region. All were accepted as eligible.
5. Recommendation that the following candidates for election as Trustees of the General Service Board be presented to the General Service Conference for its disapproval, if any, and then to the General Service Board for election at its Annual Meeting in April:

NON-A.A. TRUSTEES

Travis Dancey, M.D.
Vincent Dole, M.D.
Austin MacCormick
Robert W. Morse
Hon. John Murtagh
John L. Norris, M.D.
Archibald B. Roosevelt
Bernard B. Smith
Harrison Trice, Ph.D.

A.A. TRUSTEES

Andy A.
Eric B.
Tom B.
Rollie D.
Don F.
Charles (Edw.) L., Jr.
Bayard P., Jr.
Katharine P.
Maurice R., Jr.
Frank R.
Ruth W.

The Committee further recommends that the name of Robert P. be presented to the General Service Conference for its disapproval, if any, as an A.A. General Service Trustee, to be elected at the July Meeting of the General Service Board.

6. Recommendation that the following officers of the General Service Board also be elected at the Annual Meeting of the General Service Board in April:

Chairman: John L. Norris, M.D.
First Vice-Chairman: Bernard B. Smith
Second Vice-Chairman: Charles (Edw.) L., Jr.
Treasurer: Robert W. Morse
Secretary: Ruth W.

7. Recommendation of the following Directors of the Board of A.A.W.S., Inc. to the General Service Board for election at the Annual April Meeting of the members of A.A.W.S., Inc.

Robert H.	Niles P.
Bayard P.	Stephen O.
Eve M. (until Sept. 1)	Charles M.
Robert P.	

8. Recommendation of the following slate of Directors of the Grapevine Board to the General Service Board for election at the October (1967) Annual Meeting of the Grapevine Corporate Board:

Charles (Edw.) L., Jr.	David B.
Tom W.	Barry L.
Ruth W.	Robert P.
Paula C.	Austin Mac Cormick
Milton Maxwell, Ph.D.	

9. Nomination of Bayard P., Jr. as an A.A. General Service Trustee.
10. Nomination of Charles M. and Robert P. as Directors of A.A.W.S., Inc.
11. Nomination of Milton A. Maxwell, Ph.D., as Director of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Following three-minute presentations and voting under Third Legacy procedures, the name of Don F. was presented to the General Service Board for election as Trustee from the West Central Region.

—Charles (Edw.) L., Jr., Chairman.

METHOD OF ELECTION CHANGED

Conference Action

Following discussion, Delegates voted to amend the procedures for electing Regional Trustees in the following manner:

1. That withdrawals start after the second ballot. If any candidate has less than 1/5 of the total vote, his name is *automatically* withdrawn — except that the TOP TWO CANDIDATES must remain. And, of course, if there are ties for second place, the top candidate and tied second-place candidates must remain.
2. After the third ballot, candidates with less than 1/3 are automatically withdrawn, but again the top two candidates must remain, or the top candidate and all tied for second place.
3. A fourth ballot is then taken. If there is no 2/3 majority, all remaining names go into the hat.

Ask-It-Basket

- Q. At large conventions, we have a registration fee and require a badge for admission to all meetings. Is it okay if someone who can't afford a fee be given a badge anyway?

A. There is no objection at all to this.

'Town Meeting' Productive

Policy

Report

The Policy Committee meets in July, October and January, on the Sunday before the General Service Board Meetings. Invited to attend these meetings are all

Trustees, A.A.W.S. Directors, G.S.O. and Grapevine Staffs, members of the Trustees' Committees on Public Information, Finance, Literature, and International. Generally between 35 and 40 are present, and the meetings continue for four hours or so. This "town meeting" format provides a wealth of A.A. experience.

Reports are received from A.A.W.S., the Grapevine, and the various Trustee Committees, as well as from the Trustees and Staff. The committee discusses A.A. policy and makes recommendations to the Board. Some of the subjects discussed at Policy meetings this past year were:

1. A.A.'s obligation to make greater efforts to reach "hard-to-reach" alcoholics.
2. A possible world service meeting.
3. The theme and agenda of the 18th General Service Conference.
4. The need for accumulating some meaningful data on continuing A.A. sobriety.
5. Supervised drawing of Panel 18 Delegates to serve on Conference Committees.

Although basically a committee to discuss general policy and to clarify our A.A. thinking and experience, the Policy Committee does make strong recommendations to the Board when indicated. Voting members at the present time are all seven Regional Trustees, two nonalcoholic Trustees, the Chairman of General Services, a Director of A.A.W.S., Director of the Grapevine Corporate Board, and two Staff Members. A Regional Trustee serves as chairman. At the April meeting following the Conference these voting members review the advisory actions of the Conference.

—Tom B., Regional Trustee,
Chairman Policy Committee.

CONFERENCE POLICY COMMITTEE

Conference Action

The Policy Committee of the Conference made the following recommendations:

1. That we maintain the present procedure for selection of Conference Committees on a geographic basis at the January Policy Meeting of the Board.
2. Thus, since the language of the General Service Conference is English, and since the Conference is not equipped to provide translators, it is desirable that Delegates elected to the Conference have a knowledge of English for their own benefit and for the benefit of their areas.
3. That consideration be given either to the preparation of Guidelines or a presentation at the Conference as to how a Conference Report should be given.

4. That when questions of importance for the Conference cannot be sent to the areas in advance, consideration be given to an oral presentation early in the Conference sessions, with discussion and voting to be taken at a later date during the Conference.

5. Elected Bill B., San Diego, California, Chairman.

CLOSING SESSION

In bringing the 18th General Service Conference to a close, Bill thanked Delegates for the great efforts they had made, the time and service they had given on behalf of other members throughout the world.

"Every job is done by a unique personality," he said, pointing out that the destiny of our A.A. Fellowship hangs as much on the thoughts and actions of gifted personalities as it does on the group conscience.

John L. Norris, M.D., Chairman of the General Service Board, told Delegates that the Conference is a high point in our lives, but we do have to come down off the mountain-top to the plains where the real work has to be done.

"Communication must be a two-way street to be effective," he said, noting that Delegates should not hesitate to ask questions in order to understand and participate fully—"because that is where the paydirt is."

Katharine P., Trustee from the Southeast Region, spoke of coming to A.A. 20 years ago when meetings weren't listed and you heard about it through word of mouth. She told of the trouble she had getting sober and described this lonely period, when "I had a sort of gangrene of the soul, because I had decided that I was an alcoholic but that A.A. wouldn't work for me." Finally she decided that she was willing to do anything to get sober and stay sober. "Since that time God has been very good to me."

WITH 'RELIEF AND GRIEF'

Murray W., retiring as G.S.B. Trustee, described himself as having mixed emotions — relief and grief — as his six years of service at the General Service Office came to an end. "During this period I have come to know and love the fine people at G.S.O. — Staff, volunteers, and those very devoted non-A.A.'s who give so much of their time and talent."

He pointed out that rotation in A.A. does not mean the end of service. "It means that we can hand the torch to a new, fresh runner," he said. "It assures us of a perpetual source of talent—people who can use the full force of their energy because they don't have to hold back for the long stretch."

BILL'S STATEMENT ON HIS FINANCES

At the 1957 Conference, Bill read to the Delegates the following letter addressed to Mr. Archibald B. Roosevelt, Treasurer of the General Service Board.

Dear Archie,

As many are aware, I have long felt that my personal finances should always be an open book to our membership. Ever since 1951, when the General Service Conference first met, my book royalties and my expense allowances have been shown in each year's audits. This practice will, of course be continued.

This year, however, I would like to make a full accounting for all monies received by me from 1938, when the Alcoholic Foundation was created, to 1955 when, at St. Louis, the Conference and its General Service Board assumed final responsibility for A.A.'s world affairs.

This seventeen-year audit has been prepared by Mr. Wilbur Smith, our CPA, and is here enclosed. Saving the small amount I received as a result of Mr. Rockefeller's 1940 dinner, it can be seen that my whole income over those years has derived only from A.A. Publishing activities. My other services to the Headquarters were all volunteer.

I earnestly recommend that this detailed accounting be always shown to every Conference Delegate on request; and further that a copy of this audit be placed on permanent file at the New York Headquarters where, on request, it can be read by any visiting A.A. member.

Ever yours,

Bill

(Signed in full)

WGW/nw

P.S. I hope the Conference sees fit to publish this letter each year in its annual report.

KEYNOTE (from p. 8)

thinking, and many times they will have very convincing arguments. But these arguments will only be convincing to those of us who do not fully understand our history, and the reasons that brought about our Traditions in the first place. It is up to you and me as servants of A.A. to continue to carry the message of how and why our Traditions of unity evolved, and in doing this we will come to see that they are as vital today as they were yesterday, and I suspect more so.

Pressure on A.A.?

At this very minute things are happening at the level of government and law that will put tremendous pressure on A.A. to get involved in many projects and areas of alcoholism that we really have no right to be in, as a Fellowship. Many tempting morsels are going to be thrown at us as individuals, as groups, and as areas, etc. It is going to take a deep understanding of our Traditions to avoid the pitfalls that lie ahead. I know of no better group of A.A.'s to carry this message to our Fellowship than you and I as members of this Conference.

It has been my privilege on many occasions over the past few years to hear Bill explain the need to adhere to our present Traditions, by going back into the history of A.A. and relating it to the present. I am sure that if you and I can do this in our own areas we will have nothing to fear. An informed fellowship is a sound fellowship.

In my experience in our Fellowship I have seen the collapse of unity in an area on a number of occasions. And on very rare occasions was it brought about by drastic breaks from our Traditions. It inevitably started insidiously, by Traditions being ignored or stretched slightly. We will always hear the old reasons or excuses... "this is a special, different, or unique case or situation," or "...for convenience sake," or... the one that really goes over, "this will improve communications between our different service areas." In my experience there has been no situation in our history, in which our Traditions did not hold up.

Again a knowledge of our history and relating it to the present is the best approach in all cases. And I am convinced that you, as members of the General Service Conference, are the best line of communications in carrying this message to the Fellowship. You are involved in world service, you have a knowledge of our

history and the history of our Traditions, and you are the direct link between G.S.O. and the grass roots. This I believe is a very large part of your responsibility and mine to share the reasons for our Traditions, as they emerged out of our history, and to relate them to today, and to all the todays that shall follow.

Finally, one of the great Traditions in our Unity Legacy is Tradition Two which says in effect that in A.A. and in our individual lives we have but "one ultimate authority, a loving God as He may express Himself through our group conscience." The state of our group conscience will be directly dependent on how you and I as individual members of A.A. practice our Steps of recovery, how well we understand our history as a fellowship, and the need to adhere to our unity Traditions today.

We will continue to have unity in A.A., and hence survive as a fellowship, as the direct result of not one, but many things: (1) Continued practice and faith in the Twelve Steps of recovery; (2) A growing knowledge and understanding of our history and the involvement of our Twelve Traditions; (3) Continued service to A.A. wherever we are asked to serve. I am convinced that only by this total involvement in our way of life will we continue to have and maintain unity. —Tom B., Regional Trustee, Canada West

Ask-It-Basket

- Q. What about A.A. members forming clubs and possessing real estate and buildings to provide full-time facilities for their members — TV room, pool room, etc.? (Financing is obtained by public projects such as bingo games and rental of space to outside organizations. This club is chartered under its own charter name (not "A.A."). A.A. then rents space from the club for its meetings and functions and, as such, is self-supporting.)
- A. There has been much discussion about this subject the last two years. While there is no such thing as an A.A. club, there are many clubs that are supported by A.A. members. The Conference in 1967 voted in favor of suggesting that clubs which are supported by A.A.'s follow the Traditions of A.A. in the same sense as A.A. groups do. Guidelines are available from G.S.O. on how clubs can function more effectively within the Traditions.

Financial Picture Satisfactory

Finance

Report

The total financial picture for the past year is most satisfactory. Net sales income increased \$98,600 over 1966. Of this, \$61,000 was due to the sales of the new book "The A.A. Way of Life," \$13,000 to sales of the new comic-book pamphlet "What Happened to Joe," and the balance to increased publishing activity. Group contributions increased 9.8% (\$31,043) over 1966. Actual expenses came within less than 1% of the budgeted figure.

The 1968 G.S.O. budget was reviewed by the committee. The budget allows for a 2.8% increase in sales. This is a conservative estimate because of the unusual increase of 1967 sales.

Since joining the General Service Board, I am constantly impressed with the way G.S.O. handles its money problems...with enough care to suit even a banker. But, I am again concerned to learn that not all groups have been contributing...and that the cost of services is not being met by contributions. Although contributions are better this year, they still are not matching service costs.

The A.A. doctrine of self-support is indeed unique and all groups must work hard to maintain the dignity, strength and character of our organization. With the A.A. Tradition that no contributions be taken from foundations or other outside sources, it becomes very important that all A.A. groups and individuals share in the cost of our worldwide services.

—Robert W. Morse, Chairman
Trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee

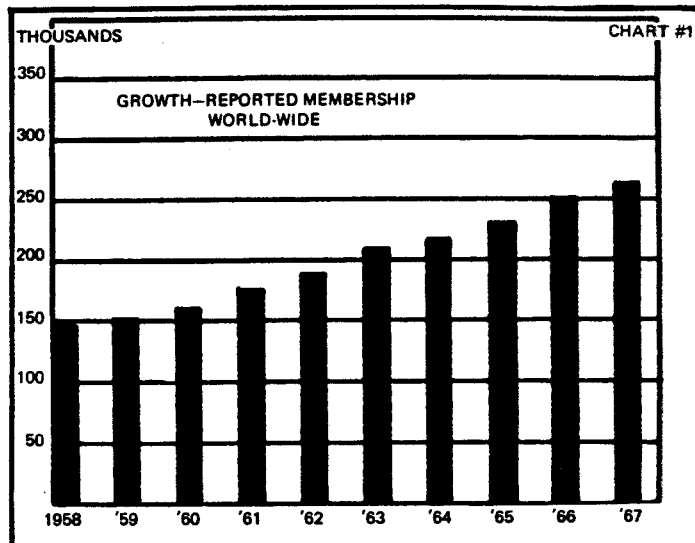
A DECADE OF GROWTH

Presentation

In the past ten years, G.S.O. has witnessed a remarkable period of growth. Membership has increased by the tens of thousands and numbers of groups by thousands. Of course, a growth pattern such as this naturally increases the cost of services and responsibility of the groups to support these services to further carry the message.

An involved list of figures and statistics has a way of complicating a report and can make listening or reading out and out dull. I believe these simple charts will do a better job of telling the story.

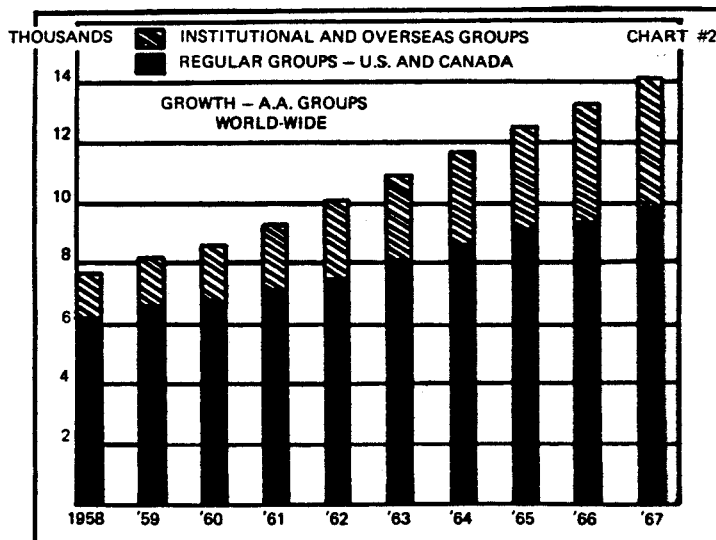
Chart #1 shows the growth of membership on a year-to-year basis from 1958 through 1967. This is the membership reported by the groups for publication in the annual *World Directory*. From left to right, the bars showing years from 1958 to 1967 tell us that the membership has not grown in stops and spurts, but in a strong, steady upward flow. An increase in membership, from a reported 145,000 in 1958, to 263,800 in 1967 indicates a healthy growth factor. This chart also reminds us that as membership expands, services have to keep pace.



Over ten years reported membership has grown from 145,000 to 263,800, an increase of 81%. This gain was accomplished on a steady year-by-year basis.

Chart #2 not only shows us how the number of groups has increased over the past ten years, but also illustrates that the more dependent groups (institutional and overseas) have had a greater ratio of increase. In 1958, out of a total of 7,765 groups registered, 20% were either institutional or overseas. (These groups are represented by the shaded portion of the growth bars.) In 1967 this percentage had increased to 30%.

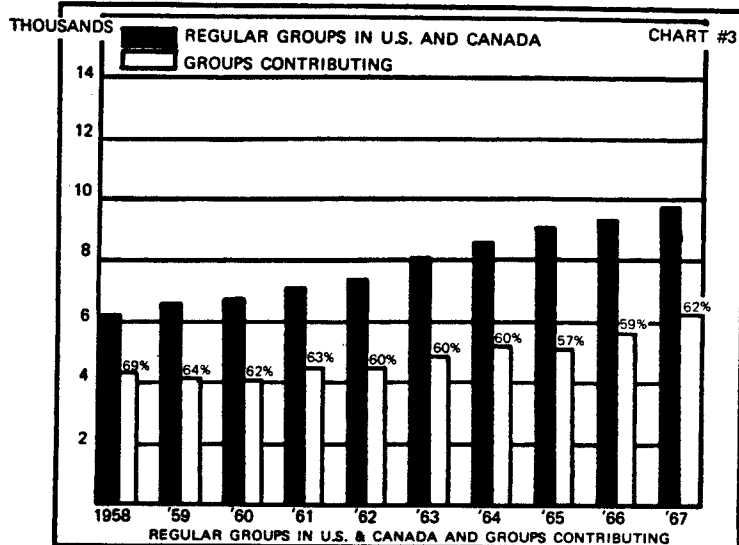
Groups overseas and institutional groups can only afford to make a token contribution to the cost of General Services... overseas groups because of monetary restrictions and institutional groups for obvious reasons. Regular groups in the United States and Canada are therefore responsible for 98.5% of all service costs.



From 1958 to the present, groups registered have increased from 7,765 to 14,154 — an increase of 82%. In 1967, 30% of all groups were institutional and overseas, compared to only 20% in 1958.

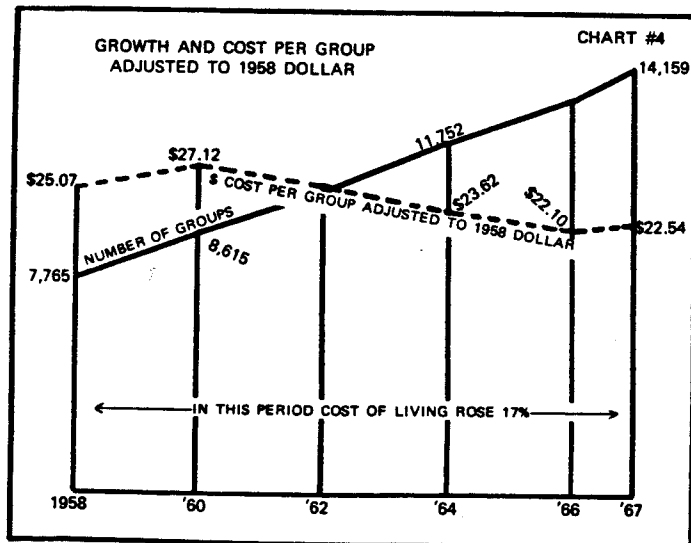
Chart #3 shows us how the groups in the U.S. and Canada are handling this responsibility. In 1958 we see that 69% of these groups were contributing while in 1967 only 62% were participating. However, note that while a low of 57% was reached in 1965 an increase has been maintained over the last two years. The response of the groups to the Regular Contribution Plan is a major factor in this upswing.

As the Fellowship has grown year by year, the purchasing power of the dollar has declined. We are constantly doing what we can to cut basic costs so that inflation and the cost of more services to more groups will still leave us with a workable budget. Without reducing group services the service cost per group has been kept from rising.



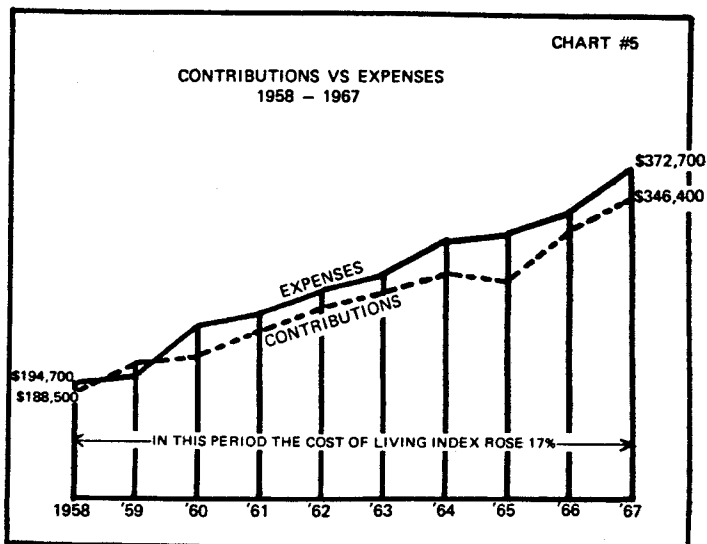
Regular groups in the U.S. & Canada are responsible for 98.5% of all service costs. In 1958, 69% of the groups participating; in 1967 only 62% participating. Groups overseas, with a lower economy, & institutional groups for obvious reasons, can only make a token contribution to general service costs.

Chart #4 shows that when we adjust to the 1958 dollar the service cost per group has actually declined. In 1958 with 7,765 groups registered, the cost per group was \$25.07. Allowing for the 17% cost of living increase since that time, the 1967 cost was actually down to \$22.54.



Without reducing groups services, constant striving for increased efficiency has kept service cost per group from rising. When cost of service per group is adjusted to a 1958 base, service cost decreased from \$25.07 to \$22.54.

Looking at Chart #5, we can see that with only one exception, in 1959, contributions have not kept pace with the increasing service costs brought about by growth... an 81% increase in membership and an 80% increase in the number of groups. We are doing all that we can, in big and little ways, to keep costs in line. As much service as possible is being squeezed from every dollar.



The past decade has seen an increase of over 80% in total number of registered groups. Despite this growth & better efficiency of operation, Chart #5 shows our past ten years, contributions, with one exception, have not met the cost of service expenses.

All evidence indicates that the Regular Contribution Plan, if we give it the help it needs, can bring group contributions up to the point where they carry the cost of group services. Through this plan we have contact with all groups via the quarterly mailings of contribution statements. Because of this they are encouraged to correspond more frequently and take advantage of the services available. Knowing that G.S.O. means worldwide service, more and more groups will realize that these services deserve the support of every group.

It is up to all of us to tell the groups and A.A.'s everywhere that the Regular Contribution Plan is a simple business-like solution to the problem of self-support and insurance for continued growth.

—Dennis Manders, Controller

CONFERENCE FINANCE COMMITTEE

Conference Action

The Finance Committee of the General Service Conference took the following actions:

1. Approved the Board Finance Committee Report.
2. Approved the 1968 G.S.O. and Grapevine budgets.
3. Recommended that the R.C.P. flyer be mailed again to all groups, strongly stressing that Committee Members, G.S.R.'s, Secretaries, etc. be kept well informed of any mailings such as this in order to help stimulate interest in contributing to G.S.O.
4. Stressed the need for better communication between the Delegates, Committee Members, G.S.R.'s and groups, pointing out that better informed groups will support G.S.O. without the need of a "hard sell" from the Delegate.
5. Elected Bob F., S.W. Ohio and Northern Kentucky, Chairman.

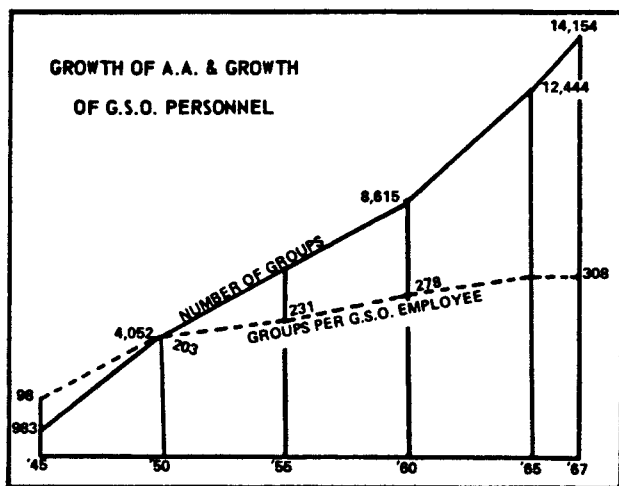
GROWTH & MONEY AT G.S.O.

1968 G.S.O. Budget

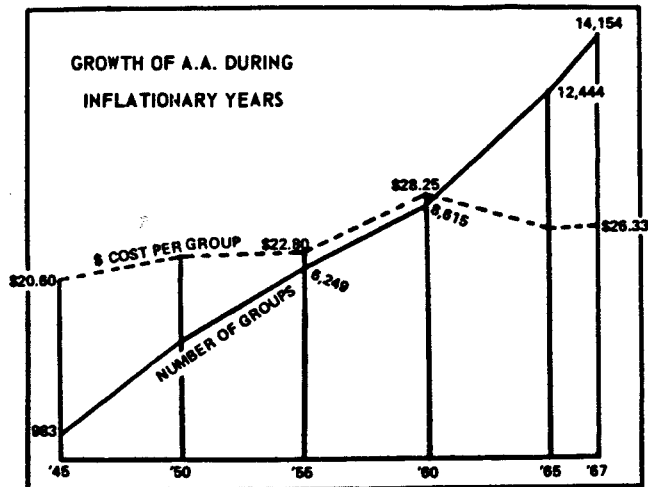
How efficient has been G.S.O.'s growth? In terms of personnel — In 1945 there was one employee for each 98 Groups. Today, one employee serves each 308 Groups.

During the past twenty two years, the G.S.O. budget has increased from \$20,000 to \$402,000 for services charged to the Group contribution account. During that same period, cost of living increased 83%. Adjusting for this change in dollar value, we find that the cost of services per Group actually showed a decrease from \$20.60 to \$14.35.

	Groups	Employees	Groups per Employee	\$ Cost per Group	Living Cost
1945	983	10	98	\$20.60	100
1950	4,052	20	202	22.06	139
1955	6,249	27	230	22.81	148
1960	8,615	31	278	28.25	165
1967	14,154	47	308	26.33	183



1. (Above) There are more than 14 times as many Groups today as in 1945. The number of services has increased greatly, too, in the same period. Today, however, there are 308 Groups for each G.S.O. employee, compared with only 98 in 1945.



2. (Above) During the years 1945 through 1967, the cost of living increased 83 percent. Constant striving for increased efficiency succeeded in keeping G.S.O. service cost per Group to \$26.33 in 1967 compared with \$20.60 in 1945, an increase of only 28 percent.

The budget for 1968 Operations of G.S.O. activities — exclusive of the A.A. Grapevine — is as follows:

BUDGET

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC.—PUBLISHING

INCOME

Sales	\$425,300*
Less: Cost of Products	170,500
Gross Profit from Sales	254,800

TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of Income (Expense)	\$ 89,800
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*Based upon the sale of:

- 39,800 Books—"Alcoholics Anonymous"
- 13,800 Books—"12 Steps & 12 Traditions" (Reg.)
- 3,700 Books—"12 Steps & 12 Traditions" (Pocket)
- 4,400 Books—"A.A. Comes of Age"
- 22,000 Books—"The A.A. Way of Life"
- Pamphlets & Miscellaneous Items

OFFICE EXPENSES — GROUP SERVICES

INCOME

Contributions	\$365,000
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TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of Income (Expense)	\$ (37,200)
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**Includes cost of General Service Conference—\$33,200.

GENERAL FUND—TRUSTEES' EXPENSES

INCOME

\$ —0—

TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of Income (Expense)	33,000***
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***Board Meetings, PIC Expense, Special Projects, etc.

The Publishing activity will contribute \$70,200 to the budgeted deficits.

1968 Grapevine Budget

Estimated income from subscription and bulk sales.....	\$203,000
Estimated expenses.....	197,500
Net income from operations.....	5,500
Interest from savings accounts	5,100
Net income	\$ 10,600

1967 Group Contributions

U.S.	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	# Gps. R.C.P.	% of Gps. on R.C.P.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. per Capita
Alabama	68	42	61.8%	11	26.2%	\$ 2,855.51	1,273	\$ 2.24
Alaska	36	17	47.2	5	29.0	1,228.50	399	3.08
Arizona	116	69	59.5	11	15.9	3,683.62	1,401	2.63
Arkansas	57	43	75.5	16	37.2	2,152.57	873	2.47
California	1,243	703	56.5	220	31.2	47,486.23	25,848	1.84
Colorado	89	58	65.1	15	25.9	3,317.73	1,429	2.32
Connecticut	164	93	56.7	26	27.9	6,483.50	2,822	2.30
Delaware	29	24	82.7	7	29.2	1,117.00	416	2.69
Dist. of Columbia	44	37	84.0	17	45.9	3,823.10	1,063	3.60
Florida	282	167	59.2	54	32.3	13,806.17	4,023	3.43
Georgia	137	89	64.9	22	24.8	4,532.70	1,864	2.43
Hawaii	27	11	40.7	3	27.2	577.00	363	1.59
Idaho	32	23	71.8	3	13.0	915.72	342	2.68
Illinois	622	586	94.2	36	6.1	9,662.15	11,248	.86
Indiana	195	110	56.4	19	17.2	5,526.50	2,470	2.24
Iowa	103	63	61.1	13	20.6	4,752.20	2,134	2.23
Kansas	100	55	55.0	4	7.3	2,894.43	1,801	1.61
Kentucky	95	67	70.5	4	5.9	4,772.17	1,201	3.97
Louisiana	96	58	60.4	12	20.8	3,329.15	1,455	2.30
Maine	52	40	76.9	6	15.0	1,509.25	545	2.77
Maryland	119	86	72.2	18	20.9	4,344.00	1,632	2.67
Massachusetts	256	142	55.4	35	24.6	8,451.67	4,886	1.73
Michigan	384	234	60.9	61	26.0	14,296.50	6,964	2.05
Minnesota	279	200	71.7	17	8.5	7,910.62	5,486	1.44
Mississippi	43	27	60.8	5	18.7	1,360.50	642	2.12
Missouri	178	95	53.4	19	20.0	6,456.61	2,464	2.62
Montana	44	34	77.3	4	11.8	1,076.78	456	2.36
Nebraska	75	44	58.7	6	13.7	2,039.57	781	2.61
Nevada	52	27	51.9	10	37.0	1,124.86	718	1.57
New Hampshire	34	23	67.7	8	34.9	1,466.40	568	2.58
New Jersey	257	171	66.5	55	32.1	9,997.64	3,950	2.53
New Mexico	59	33	55.9	6	18.2	2,120.91	1,056	2.01
New York	561	359	63.9	141	39.2	28,009.11	10,103	2.77
North Carolina	162	111	68.5	15	13.6	5,122.90	2,436	2.10
North Dakota	46	24	52.2	3	12.5	946.00	459	2.06
Ohio	446	250	56.1	40	16.0	15,126.35	8,858	1.71
Oklahoma	120	76	63.3	38	50.0	5,518.98	1,575	3.50
Oregon	115	76	66.1	23	30.2	2,906.81	1,095	2.65
Pennsylvania	299	200	66.9	46	23.0	13,799.46	4,542	3.04
Rhode Island	33	18	54.6	6	33.3	1,366.01	452	3.02
South Carolina	84	41	48.8	8	19.5	2,520.90	1,313	1.92
South Dakota	51	32	62.7	6	18.7	1,430.00	840	1.70
Tennessee	82	49	59.7	12	24.6	2,760.50	1,318	2.09
Texas	411	230	55.7	48	20.8	14,739.37	7,713	1.91
Utah	62	31	50.0	12	38.7	1,151.50	733	1.57
Vermont	27	21	77.7	3	14.2	1,672.00	378	4.42
Virginia	137	85	72.1	23	27.0	5,804.93	2,114	2.75
Washington	176	121	68.8	34	35.5	7,256.58	2,157	3.36
West Virginia	44	32	72.8	9	28.1	1,860.00	569	3.60
Wisconsin	190	123	64.7	13	10.5	4,880.30	2,441	2.00
Wyoming	25	17	68.0	1	5.8	468.00	259	1.81
Commonwealth of P.R.	44	18	40.9	4	22.2	1,056.10	604	1.75
Canal Zone	2	1	50.0	1	100.0	355.00	34	10.44
Total for U.S.	8,484	5,386	63.5%	1,234	22.9%	\$303,822.06	142,566	\$ 2.13

CANADA	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	# Gps. R.C.P.	% of Gps. on R.C.P.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. per Capita
Alberta	136	74	54.4%	14	18.9%	\$ 3,106.24	1,378	\$ 2.25
Atlantic Prov.								
New Brunswick	43	27	62.8	5	18.5	835.45	499	1.67
Newfoundland	13	6	46.2	3	50.0	376.67	166	2.27
Nova Scotia	55	29	52.8	10	34.8	1,285.65	709	1.82
Prince Ed. Is.	17	12	71.0	3	25.0	563.00	294	1.92
British Columbia	195	111	57.9	22	19.8	5,808.68	2,357	2.46
Manitoba	75	41	54.7	7	17.1	2,589.23	1,361	1.90
N.W. Territories	1	1	100.0	0	0.0	40.00	12	3.33
Ontario	420	247	58.8	62	25.1	14,279.64	6,088	2.35
Quebec	323	164	50.8	39	23.8	4,620.83	5,398	.86
Saskatchewan	130	69	53.1	6	8.7	3,439.31	1,400	2.46
Yukon Terr.	3	1	33.3	0	0.0	40.00	33	1.21
TOTAL for CANADA	1,411	782	55.5%	171	21.9%	\$ 36,984.70	19,695	\$ 1.88
TOTAL for U.S. and CANADA	9,895	6,168	62.3%	1,405	22.8%	\$340,806.76	162,261	\$ 2.10
FOREIGN								
Foreign	2,784					\$ 3,408.93	54,744	
Lone Members							297	
World Hello						64.95		
International Doctors						125.00		
Hospital Gps.	645					919.97	16,307	
Prison Groups	830					203.90	29,870	
Internationalist						599.40	318	
GRAND TOTAL	14,154					\$346,128.91	263,797	

GROUP CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON -- 1967 - 1966

	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	# Gps. R.C.P.	% of Gps. on R.C.P.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. per Capita
U.S.A. 1967	8,484	5,386	63.5%	1,234	22.9%	\$303,822.06	142,566	\$ 2.13
U.S.A. 1966	8,171	4,858	59.5	1,009	20.8	275,803.24	138,756	1.99
Increase (Decrease)	313	528	4.0%	225	2.1%	\$ 28,018.82	3,810	\$.14
Canada 1967	1,411	782	55.5%	171	21.9%	\$ 36,984.70	19,695	\$ 1.88
Canada 1966	1,282	762	59.5	88	11.7	34,474.15	18,630	1.85
Increase (Decrease)	129	20	(4.0)%	83	10.2%	\$ 2,510.55	1,065	\$.03
U.S.A. & Canada '67	9,895	6,168	62.3%	1,405	22.8%	\$340,806.76	162,261	\$ 2.10
U.S.A. & Canada '66	9,452	5,620	59.5	1,096	19.5	310,277.39	157,386	1.97
Increase (Decrease)	443	548	2.8%	309	3.3%	\$ 30,529.37	4,875	\$.13

INCOME STATEMENT

EXHIBIT A

The General Service Office

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1967

	<u>1967</u>	<u>1966</u>
INCOME		
Net Sales, after Book Discounts waived of \$32,148 in 1967 and \$22,849 in 1966	\$413,661	\$315,047
Less: Cost of Printing	118,240	90,658
Royalties	46,990	32,427
	<u>248,431</u>	<u>191,962</u>
Gross Profit from Literature	248,431	191,962
Contributions – A.A. Groups and Members	346,431	315,388
– The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	7,000	5,000
– Other	373	619
	<u>353,804</u>	<u>320,997</u>
Total Income	<u>\$602,235</u>	<u>\$512,969</u>
EXPENSES		
Salaries	\$290,286	\$257,623
Rent	34,725	34,386
Exchange Bulletin	13,053	11,401
World Directory	18,874	15,950
Other Service Office Printing	9,158	4,826
Shipping and Mailing	39,915	34,303
Other Office Expenses	46,655	45,408
Insurance and Taxes	24,358	22,750
Professional Services, Gifts	6,400	11,700
Board, Committee, Staff Meetings	9,838	8,385
Writing, Research, Bedford Hills	16,207	14,594
P.I.C., Travel	4,767	6,920
General Service Conference	32,388	31,905
Foreign Literature Aid	2,206	3,147
Film, Film Strip, Display Boards	4,723	1,991
Provision for EDP installation	20,000	
	<u>\$573,553</u>	<u>\$505,289</u>
Total Expense	<u>\$573,553</u>	<u>\$505,289</u>
EXCESS OF INCOME (EXPENSE) (Exhibit C)	<u>28,682</u>	<u>7,680</u>
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) BY FUNCTION		
World Service Office – Group Fund	\$(26,294)	\$(19,793)
Publishing – A.A. World Services, Inc.	74,796	49,242
General Fund – General Service Board	(19,820)	(21,769)
CHANGES IN OTHER FUNDS – 1967		
	<u>Convention</u>	<u>Pension</u>
Balance, January 1, 1967		\$ 10,731
Book Discounts		32,148
Contribution by A.A. Grapevine, Inc.		3,500
Investment Income	\$ 588	908
Transfers (to) from Other Funds	6,500	30,000
Subscriptions to Fund	6,328	
Less: Current Funding Costs		(34,968)
Additional Funding of Past Service Liability		(20,000)
Actuary Fee		(1,964)
	<u>\$ 13,416</u>	<u>\$ 20,355</u>
Balance, December 31	<u>\$ 13,416</u>	<u>\$300,023</u>

() Denotes Red Figures

In the following financial statements amounts under the heading "Service Office" combine the accounts of The General Service Board of A.A., Inc. and of A.A. World Services, Inc. The latter corporation publishes books and pamphlets and pays a portion of the expenses of the General Service Office, while the accounts of The General Service Board are further subdivided into Funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND, which was established in 1954 by transfer from the General Fund of cash then on deposit in savings accounts, for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve. Its use may be authorized by the Board of Trustees, on recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The DEFERRED PENSION FUND, which was established in 1965 to receive moneys for the Retirement Plan for the benefit of employees of A.A. World Services, Inc. and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. prior to transfer to the Trustee of the A.A. Retirement Trust.

INCOME STATEMENT

The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1967

	<u>1967</u>	<u>1966</u>
INCOME — SUBSCRIPTIONS AND SALES	\$192,566	\$176,063
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING COSTS		
Salaries	36,934	35,035
Printing	42,989	42,307
Mailing	21,060	18,203
Rent	5,286	5,232
Telephone	1,139	1,099
Office Supplies and Expense	3,598	2,946
Office Cleaning	500	500
Total	<u>\$111,506</u>	<u>\$105,322</u>
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries	\$ 33,839	\$ 29,852
Stationery and Supplies	1,915	1,572
Rent	5,285	5,232
Telephone	870	839
Office Expense	2,644	2,153
Bad Debts	271	392
Conference and Convention	—	243
Selling	5,122	5,747
Postage	3,756	3,298
Office Cleaning	500	500
Total	<u>\$ 54,202</u>	<u>\$ 49,828</u>
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Insurance	\$ 3,239	\$ 2,980
Legal and Accounting	2,400	2,400
Taxes	4,489	4,277
Meetings	484	429
New Equipment	463	73
Contribution to Retirement Plan	3,500	3,500
Total	<u>\$ 14,575</u>	<u>\$ 13,659</u>
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>\$180,283</u>	<u>\$168,809</u>
INCOME FROM OPERATIONS	\$ 12,283	\$ 7,254
Add: Interest Received on Savings Accounts	4,168	3,613
NET INCOME FOR PERIOD (Exhibit C)	<u>\$ 16,451</u>	<u>\$ 10,867</u>

The GROUP CONTRIBUTION FUND, which was established in 1941 to receive contributions from A.A. Groups and members to be used solely for the expenses of the General Service Office, and, subsequently, for the costs of the General Service Conference.

The GENERAL FUND, which is comprised of those assets not included in either of the other Funds and which may be used for any of the purposes for which the corporation was formed.

The CONVENTION GUARANTY FUND was established in 1967 by subscriptions from A.A. members in Miami, Florida and by a transfer from the GENERAL FUND for the purpose of making up a deficit, if any, incurred in connection with the Convention to be held in Miami in 1970. To the extent it is not used it is to be refunded to the original subscribers.

In the financial statements the net worth and net operating results for the year of A.A. World Services, Inc. are referred to as Publishing, of the Group Contribution Fund as World Service Office, and of the other Funds by their names.

COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

EXHIBIT C

The General Service Office and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1967

	December 31, 1967		December 31, 1966	
	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine
OPERATING FUND				
ASSETS				
Cash	\$155,999	\$ 32,258	\$108,283	\$ 26,407
Saving Accounts and Certificates	12,200	95,009		83,871
Accounts Receivable	11,792	2,554	8,631	2,750
Dues from Grapevine or Reserve Fund	25,500		5,000	
Inventories	85,400	1,217	83,900	1,960
Prepaid Expenses	6,197	8,685	9,104	8,098
Total Assets	\$297,088	\$139,723	\$214,918	\$123,086
DEDUCT LIABILITIES				
Accounts and Accruals Payable	20,066	5,746	11,458	2,433
Due Pension Fund	22,361		1,681	
Due General Fund		7,000		5,000
Prepaid Subscriptions, Unearned Income		76,810		74,937
Reserve for Retirement Plan Payments		7,000		7,000
Reserve for EDP Installation	20,000			
Total Liabilities	\$ 62,427	\$ 96,556	\$ 13,139	\$ 89,370
NET WORTH				
Balance, January 1	201,779	33,716	\$194,099	34,849
Net Income (Expenses) for Year (Exhibits A and B)	28,682	16,451	7,680	10,867
Donation to General Fund		(7,000)		(5,000)
Transfer (to) from:				
Reserve for Retirement Plan Payments				(7,000)
Reserve Fund	30,700			
Convention Guaranty Fund	(6,500)			
Deferred Pension Fund	(20,000)			
Total Net Worth	\$234,661	\$ 43,167	\$201,779	\$ 33,716
NET WORTH BY FUNCTION OR FUND				
World Service Office - Group Fund (Note B)	\$ 11,184		\$ 11,179	
Publishing - A.A. World Services, Inc. (Note A)	152,278		127,481	
General Fund - G.S.B. (Notes A and B)	71,199		63,119	
Total Operating Funds - as above	\$234,661		\$201,779	
Reserve Fund	300,023		326,874	
Deferred Pension Fund	20,355		10,731	
Convention Guaranty Fund	13,416			
Total Net Worth	\$568,455		\$539,384	
RESERVE, DEFERRED PENSION AND CONVENTION GUARANTY FUNDS	Reserve	Pension		Convention
Cash	\$ 1,000			
Saving Accounts and Certificates	24,551	\$ 26,640		\$ 13,416
Dues from A.A.W.S. and General Fund		22,361		
U.S. Treasury Obligations	254,983			
Government Agency and Corporate Bonds	34,320			
Accrued Interest	3,669	306		
Less: Due General Fund	(18,500)			
A.A. Retirement Trust		(28,952)		
PRINCIPAL OF FUND	\$300,023	\$ 20,355		\$ 13,416

() Denotes Red Figures

NOTE A - After transfers of \$50,000 in 1967, and \$49,000 in 1966 from Publishing to General Fund.

NOTE B - Advances of \$26,300 in 1967 and \$20,000 in 1966 were made by the General Fund to the Group Contribution Fund to make up deficits in Group contributions in those years.

The attached financial statements and above notes have been prepared by the independent certified public accountants from the figures contained in their reports on the three separate corporations.

1968 CONFERENCE MEMBERS*

Trustees, A.A.W.S. Directors, G.S.O. & Grapevine Staffs

Bill Wilson — Co-founder

G.S.B. TRUSTEES

NONALCOHOLIC

John L. Norris, M.D. (Chairman)
Associate Medical Director
Eastman Kodak Company

Travis E. Dancey, M.D.
4015 Wilson Avenue
Montreal 28, Quebec, Canada

Vincent Dole, M.D.
Rockefeller Inst.
67th St. & York Ave.
New York, New York 10021

Leonard V. Harrison (Emeritus)
Box 383
Old Lyme, Connecticut 06371

Austin H. MacCormick
Osborne Association
114 East 30th Street
New York, New York 10016

Robert W.P. Morse (Treasurer)
Cove Road
Oyster Bay, L.I., N.Y. 11771

Hon. John Murtagh
Justice of the Supreme Court of
the State of N.Y.
100 Center Street
New York, New York 10013

Archibald B. Roosevelt
Roosevelt & Cross
40 Wall Street
New York, New York 10005

Bernard B. Smith (1st Vice Chairman)
460 Park Avenue
New York, New York 10022

Harrison M. Trice, Ph.D.
School of Industrial & Labor Relations
Cornell University
Ithaca, New York 14850

ALCOHOLIC

Arthur "Andy" Anderson
3565 Sunset Lane
Port Huron, Michigan 48060

Eric H. Bergman
8435 47 Avenue South
Seattle, Washington 98118

Tom Breen
Box 453
Lac du Bonnet, Manitoba, Canada

Rollie G. Davidson
Penthouse Apt.
3462 Aylmer Street
Montreal 2, Quebec, Canada

Charles E. Lalanne, Jr. (Secretary)
405 Lexington Avenue
New York, New York 10017

Bayard Pope, Jr.
B.B.D. & O.
383 Madison Avenue
New York, New York

Katharine Prince
2305 Chidester Road
Camden, Arkansas 71701

Maurice E. Reilly, Jr.
7726 Jeannette Street
New Orleans, Louisiana 70118

Frank Russell
159 Wentworth Avenue
Lowell, Massachusetts 01850

Ruth M. Weir
145 East 15 Street
New York, New York 10003

**Murray Whitsett (2nd Vice Chairman)
11 Church Street
New Canaan, Connecticut 06840

A.A. GRAPEVINE DIRECTORS

Charles E. Lalanne, Jr. (Chairman)
Tom White (President)
Paula Carpenter (Vice President, Secretary)
Ruth Weir (Treasurer)
David A. Barron
Barry Leach
Austin MacCormick
Milton Maxwell, Ph. D.
Robert G. Pearson

A.A. WORLD SERVICES DIRECTORS

Robert E. Hitchins (Chairman)
Bayard Pope, Jr. (1st Vice Chairman)
Eve Marsh (2nd Vice Chairman)
Murray Whitsett (Treasurer)
Charles Milton
Stephen C. Owen, Sr.
Niles Peebles
Hazel Rice (Secretary)

GRAPEVINE STAFF

Tom White
Paula Carpenter
Jack Morley

GENERAL SERVICE OFFICE STAFF

Robert E. Hitchins
Cora Louise Belford
Beth Kuhlmann
Ann Macfarlane
Eve Marsh
Midge McFadden
Waneta New
Hazel Rice

***Term ending following Conference (see p. 44 for A.A. Trustee
elected G.S.B. meeting, April 27, 1968)*

G.S.O. DEPT. HEADS

Al Cryan
Rose Failla
Kleina Jones
Dennis Manders
Nell Wing

CONSULTANTS

Janet Graves
(Public Information)
Wilbur A. Smith
(Ind. C.P.A.)

Two Observers from: Public Information Committee
Two Observers from: International Committee
Two Observers from: Grapevine Editorial Board

*Members of Conference other than Area Delegates

APRIL 1968

Nonalcoholic Trustees

John L. Norris, M.D. — is Chairman of the General Service Board and the Service Conference. He was elected to the Board in January, 1951. "Dr. Jack" is Associate Medical Director of the Eastman Kodak Company in Rochester, New York. Chairman of the Governor's Committee on Alcoholism. President of the Industrial Medical Association. As his record in and out of A.A. suggests, he has contributed much to the understanding and rehabilitation of alcoholics.

Travis E. Dancey, M.D. — Elected to the Board in January, 1965. Dr. Dancey is Chief of Service/Psychiatry at Queen Mary Veterans Hospital and Senior Psychiatrist at Montreal General Hospital. He has been a good friend of the Fellowship since the formation of the first A.A. group in Quebec. He is the first non-alcoholic Trustee to serve from Canada. Dr. Dancey serves on the Trustees' Nominating and Policy Committees.

Vincent P. Dole, M.D. — Elected to the General Service Board in April, 1965. He is a Professor & Senior Physician at the Rockefeller Institute Hospital. Dr. Dole developed method used in the treatment of narcotic addiction; he is active in organizations dealing with this health problem. He serves on the International Committee, a subcommittee of the Trustees' Policy Committee.

Austin H. MacCormick — Elected to the General Service Board in April, 1961. An early friend of A.A., he had served on the Board previously from October, 1949 to April, 1951. He left in 1951 to become Professor of Criminology at the University of California in Berkeley, and on his retirement in 1960, returned to New York as Executive Director of the Osborne Association, Inc. He is a Director of the A.A. Grapevine, a member of its Editorial Board, and also serves on the Literature and Nominating Committees.

Robert W. Morse — Elected to the General Service Board in July, 1965. Treasurer of the General Service Board and currently Chairman of the Finance & Budgetary Committee. He is Executive Vice President and Treasurer of the Dime Savings Bank of Brooklyn. Born in Nova Scotia, Canada, he became a U.S. citizen in 1921. During World War II he served as a Finance Officer in the U.S. Army in the Chinese Theatre Area. He is a Director of the Mutual Savings Bank Fund and married and the father of three children.

Hon. John M. Murtagh — Elected to the General Service Board in April, 1963; is a Justice of the Supreme Court of the State of New York. Previously, he had been Administrative Judge of the Criminal Court of New York, Chief Justice of the Court of Special Sessions, Chief City Magistrate, and Commissioner of Investigation of New York. He is married and the father of four children. The Judge has long been a good friend of A.A. and brings to the Board a sure understanding of the alcoholism illness.

Archibald B. Roosevelt — (former Treasurer of the General Service Board and the former Chairman of the Trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee) — was elected to the General Service Board in January, 1953. He is a partner in the investment firm of Roosevelt and Cross, Inc., and is well known for his interest in philanthropic affairs. He remains a member of the Finance & Budgetary Committee.

Bernard B. Smith — is 1st Vice Chairman of the General Service Board — was elected to the Board in June, 1944, and has been very active, serving as Chairman of the General Service Board and General Service Conference from January, 1951 to April, 1956. He is an attorney and author, and has made an outstanding contribution in the cause of Anglo-American understanding. In October, 1957, he received a decoration, Honorary Commander of the Order of the British Empire, from the hands of Her Majesty, Queen Elizabeth II, on her visit to the United States.

Harrison M. Trice, Ph.D. — was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1957, and has served there, and as a member of the Policy Committee, with great enthusiasm. He is an Associate Professor in the School of Industrial & Labor Relations at Cornell University. He has been a frequent contributor to professional journals, and a consultant to various study groups and to private companies on the subject of alcoholism.

Leonard V. Harrison (Emeritus) — first came on the Board in 1941, and, with the exception of his resignation from October, 1950 to January, 1953, has been continually active in A.A. affairs. He served as Chairman of the General Service Board from April, 1956 to April, 1961. For many years he served as Director of Public Affairs of the Community Service Society in New York City, but is now retired and living in Old Lyme, Conn.

A.A. Trustees

Arthur 'Andy' Anderson — was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1967, as Trustee from the East Central Region. He had his last drink in 1949. Andy was also a Delegate to the General Service Conference and helped to initiate a statewide General Service Committee and P.I. Committee. He was instrumental in forming the Michigan State Police, and is with Chrysler Corporation, in charge of government parts' inspection. Andy serves on the Trustees' Nominating and Policy Committees.

Eric H. Bergman — was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1967, as Trustee from the Pacific Region. He had his last drink in 1951. He has served as G.S.R., Vice Chairman and Chairman of the Seattle Intergroup and Delegate to the General Service Conference. He is Purchasing Manager for Sicks' Rainier Brewing Company. Eric serves on the Trustees' Finance and Policy Committees.

Tom Breen — was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1965. He was nominated by the A.A. groups in Manitoba, Canada. He had his last drink in 1956. He was assistant Director and public relations representative on the Alcoholism Foundation of Manitoba until April, 1968. He is now in business for himself. Tom is Chairman of the Trustees' Policy Committee.

Rollie G. Davidson — was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1967, as Trustee from Canada East Region. He had his last drink in 1950. He has served as General Secretary of Intergroup at Montreal; Chairman, Quebec General Service Committee; worked with the French translation of A.A. literature, and been a Delegate to the General Service Conference. He is Vice President and insurance engineer of Hagar and Pettigrew. Rollie serves on the Policy, Literature and Nominating Committees.

(continued on next page)

APRIL 1968

Charles E. Lalanne, Jr. — was elected to the General Service Board in July, 1965. He is Chairman of the A.A. Grapevine. He had his last drink in 1949 and was admitted to the New York State Bar in 1936 and has his own law firm. He serves on the Trustees' Finance and Policy Committees.

Bayard Pope, Jr. — was elected to the General Service Board as a Service Trustee in January, 1968. He had his last drink in 1959. He is presently co-Chairman of the Public Information Committee, a member of the Steering Committee for the Intergroup Association of New York, and is on the Executive Committee of the Community Council on Alcoholism. He is Vice President and Management Supervisor for Batten, Barton, Durstine and Osborn. Bayard also serves on the Trustees' Policy, Literature and Nominating Committees, and is a Director of A.A.W.S., Inc.

Katharine Prince — was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1967, as Trustee from the Southwest Region. She had her last drink in 1949 and is a member of the Camden, Arkansas Group. She has been a G.S.R. in Oklahoma and Arkansas, an area Committee Member, and helped form the Tulsoma (Oklahoma) Group. She was Assistant Secretary-Treasurer of the Southwestern Art Association. Katharine serves on the Trustees' Literature and Policy Committees.

Maurice E. Reilly, Jr. — was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1967, as Trustee from the Southeast Region. He had his last drink in 1956. He has served as G.S.R., Committee Member, State Chairman and Delegate for Louisiana. He also served as Vice Chairman of the Central Office Board. He is an architect in private practice and is a member of several professional organizations. Maurice serves on the Trustees' Finance and Policy Committees.

Frank E. Russell — was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1965, as Trustee from the Northeast Region. He came to A.A. in January, 1952. In 1954, he helped form the Bridge Street Group of Lowell, Mass. From 1961-62, he served as Delegate to the General Service Conference from Eastern Mass. He is a retired accountant. Frank is currently co-Chairman of the Trustees' Nominating Committee and serves also on the Policy Committee.

Ruth M. Weir — was elected to the General Service Board as a Service Trustee in April, 1967. She had her last drink in 1954. She has been active with the New York Intergroup Association and is a Director and Treasurer of the Grapevine Board. She is a Financial Administrator for The Interpublic Group of Companies, Inc. Ruth also serves on the Trustees' Finance and Policy Committees.

Murray Whitsett — was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1964, following two years of service as a Director of A.A. World Services, Inc. He is presently 2nd Vice Chairman of the General Service Board and Chairman of the Public Information Committee. He had his last drink in 1952 and is a member of the New Canaan, Conn. Group. He currently heads his own advertising and public relations business.

Trustees' Meeting

The Board of Trustees will meet during the coming year on the following dates: July 29, October 28, 1968; January 27 and April 26, 1969.

FINANCE & BUDGETARY

Robert W. Morse, Chairman
Eric Bergman
Robert E. Hitchins
Charles E. Lalanne, Jr.
Stephen Owen, Sr.
Maurice Reilly, Jr.
Archibald B. Roosevelt
Ruth Weir
Wilbur Smith, C.P.A. (ex officio)
Dennis Manders, Secretary

Investment Advisory Committee

Robert W. Morse, Chairman
Charles E. Lalanne, Jr.
Robert E. Hitchins
Archibald B. Roosevelt
William G. Wilson
Chester Rude, Adviser
Dennis Manders, Secretary

Retirement Committee

Robert W. Morse, Chairman
Charles E. Lalanne, Jr.
John L. Norris, M.D.
Archibald B. Roosevelt
Murray Whitsett
Wilbur Smith, C.P.A. (ex officio)
Robert E. Hitchins, Secretary

LITERATURE

Austin MacCormick, Chairman
Murray Whitsett, Co-Chairman
Joel Bennett
Rollie Davidson
Barry Leach
Frances Mines
Robert E. Hitchins
Stephen Owen, Sr.
Katharine Prince
Bayard Pope, Jr.
Joseph Warren
Tom White
Ann Macfarlane, Secretary

NOMINATING

Charles E. Lalanne, Jr.,
Chairman
Frank Russell, Co-Chairman
Andy Anderson
Travis Dancy, M.D.
Rollie Davidson
Robert E. Hitchins
Barry Leach
Austin MacCormick
Charles Milton
Bayard Pope, Jr.
Cora Louise Belford, Secretary

POLICY

Tom Breen, Chairman
Andy Anderson
Eric Bergman
Travis Dancy, M.D.
Rollie Davidson
Robert E. Hitchins
Charles E. Lalanne, Jr.
Bayard Pope, Jr.
Katharine Prince
Hazel Rice
Frank Russell
Maurice Reilly, Jr.
Prof. Harrison M. Trice
Ruth Weir
Murray Whitsett
Eve Marsh, Secretary

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Murray Whitsett, Chairman
Bayard Pope, Jr., Co-Chairman
Paula Carpenter
Jim Cassidy
Janet Graves
Robert E. Hitchins
Rex Moody
Walter Murphy
Tom Rosenberg
Robert Pearson
Niles Peebles, Consultant
Waneta New, Secretary

INTERNATIONAL

Niles Peebles, Chairman
Cora Louise Belford
Joseph Besch
Norman Crowley
Vincent Dole, M.D.
Adrian Frylink
Emma Gardner
Robert E. Hitchins
William J. Plunkert
Jean Reed
Helen Traver
Ivan Underwood
Mary Ellen Uribe
Paula Carpenter
Stephen Finch
Beth Kuhlmann, Secretary

(The International Committee is a subcommittee of the G.S.B. Policy Committee.)

1968 CONFERENCE AREA DELEGATES

STATE	PANEL
ALABAMA & N.W. FLORIDA	(17) *Ted Cooper, 128 Red Oak Road, Birmingham, Alabama
ALASKA	(18) Angus Johnson, 5900 E. Miley Avenue, Anchorage, Alaska
ARIZONA	(18) Charles Douglas, 11814 N. 36th Place, Phoenix, Arizona
ARKANSAS	(17) Max Hall, 8101 McDaniel, Little Rock, Arkansas
CALIFORNIA	(17) *Southern — Art Kolkman, 1650 Rimpau Blvd., Los Angeles, Cal. (17) Northern Coastal — Pat Sims, 77 Cunningham Way, Watsonville, Calif. (18) Northern Interior — Howard Taylor, 4628 E. El Monte, Fresno, Calif. (18) San Diego — Bill Blake, P.O. Box 719, Oceanside, California (18) Southern Coastal — Warren Snider, 671 Bay View, Laguna Beach, California
COLORADO	(17) Ray Gunther, 1532 East Buena Ventura, Colorado Springs, Colo.
CONNECTICUT	(17) Ed Smith, 179 Allyn Street, Hart- ford, Connecticut
DELAWARE	(18) Mrs. Margie Nicholson, 31 South Bradford Street, Dover, Delaware
D. C.	(17) Ernest Raskauskas, 9004 Rouen Lane, Potomac, Maryland
FLORIDA	(17) Northern — Harry Gammon, 5883 Hyde Park Circle, Jacksonville, Florida (17) Southern — F.E. (Bud) Rose, 1797 Clearwater-Largo Road, Clear- water, Florida
GEORGIA	(18) Joe L. Clements, P.O. Box 39, Vidalia, Georgia
HAWAII	(17) Wayne Wyman, 2895 Kalakaua Avenue, Honolulu, Hawaii
IDAHO	(18) Gordon Lucky, 2911 Annett, Boise, Idaho
ILLINOIS	(17) Chicago — Harry Veeneman, 10618 Walden Parkway, Chicago, Illinois (18) Northern — Joe Farley, 610 West 2nd Street, Dixon, Illinois (17) Southern — Roy Stimmel, 4902 State Street, East St. Louis, Ill.

What Do Panel Numbers Mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. This 18th Conference is made up of Panel 17 — the old Delegates — and Panel 18 — the new Delegates.

STATE	PANEL
INDIANA	(17) Northern — Robert Ellison, 5915 Monarch Dr., Fort Wayne, Indiana (18) Southern — Toy Ely, Orleans, Indiana
IOWA	(17) John Gilligan, 6301 Sherrick Ave., Des Moines, Iowa
KANSAS	(18) William P. Lowe, 721 Freemont, Manhattan, Kansas
KENTUCKY	(18) Frank Reynolds, Rt. #1, Glendale, Kentucky
LOUISIANA	(17) William Watts, 2913 N. General Wainwright, Lake Charles, La.
MAINE	(18) Lloyd Yates, Box 394, Camden, Maine
MARYLAND	(18) Ben J. Vincent, 19 Bayship Road, Baltimore, Maryland
MASSACHUSETTS	(17) Eastern — May Comeau, 13 Paul Street, Watertown, Massachusetts (18) Western — Wilfred McMahon, Gran- ville Road, Southwick, Mass.
MICHIGAN	(17) Central — Robert Budd, 804 Ryan, Owosso, Michigan (17) Southeast — Andy Piippo, 14408 Cruse, Detroit, Michigan (18) Western — Don Walker, MR 64, South Haven, Michigan
MINNESOTA	(18) Northern — Dave Harvey, 5702 Oneida, Duluth, Minnesota (17) Southern — Jim Fairfield, Route 2, Box 484, Mound, Minnesota
MISSISSIPPI	(18) Malvin J. Pogue, Box 1397, Laurel, Mississippi
MISSOURI	(17) Eastern — Al Gibson, P.O. Box 267, Ilmo, Missouri (17) Western — Verne Sorrells, 4524 J. C. Nichols Parkway, Kansas City, Missouri

ROSTER

DELEGATES (cont'd)

STATE	PANEL	STATE	PANEL
MONTANA	(18) Joseph Boyd, Ashland, Montana	RHODE ISLAND	(18) Ruth Laidlaw, Bay State Road, Rehoboth, Massachusetts
NEBRASKA	(18) James Griffin, P.O. Box 605, North Platte, Nebraska	SOUTH CAROLINA	(18) John Mooneyhan, Box 545, Sumter, South Carolina
NEVADA	(17) Les Echols, 716 Digger, Las Vegas, Nevada	SOUTH DAKOTA	(18) John Barkley, 524 N. Main, Aberdeen, South Dakota
NEW HAMPSHIRE	(18) Neil Graves, Box 63, Portsmouth, New Hampshire	TENNESSEE	(18) Tom Moore, Union Bank Bldg., Pulaski, Tennessee
NEW JERSEY	(17) Northern — Jamie Deans, 272 Prospect Avenue, Little Silver, New Jersey	TEXAS	(17) Northeast — Elizabeth Maddux, 3112 Wild Plum, Fort Worth, Texas
	(18) Southern — Aaron Klotz, 192 South Broad Street, Trenton, New Jersey		(18) Northwest — George Guy, 3407 55th Street, Lubbock, Texas
NEW MEXICO	(18) Bob Hills, P. O. Box 3461, Albuquerque, New Mexico		(17) Southeast — Ralph Monroe, 710 13th Ave., Texas City, Texas
NEW YORK	(17) Central — Steve Purtell, 95 Grand Blvd., Binghamton, New York		(18) Southwest — Carl W. Hemmi, 103 West Huisache, San Antonio, Tex.
	(18) Hudson-Mohawk-Berkshire—Chuck Danahy, 44 Coleman Avenue, Hudson Falls, New York	UTAH	(17) Pete Sumsion, 890 North First East Street, American Fork, Utah
	(17) Southeastern — Tom Mitchell, 16 Carlton Drive, Massapequa, L.I., New York	VERMONT	(18) Orlando Cullinan, Arlington, Vt.
	(18) Western — Bud Stimson, 41 Faragut Avenue, Tonawanda, New York	VIRGINIA	(17) Ernest Francisco, 2741 South Glebe Road, Arlington, Virginia
NORTH CAROLINA	(17) Dave Cooke, 229 Dublin Road, Raleigh, North Carolina	WASHINGTON	(17) Ralph Bruksos, 10204 13th Ave. South, Seattle, Washington
NORTH DAKOTA	(18) Harold Valinski, Rt. 2, Grand Forks, North Dakota	WEST VIRGINIA	(17) Sam Morningstar, 1814 Wood Street, Wheeling, West Virginia
OHIO	(17) Central & Southeast — Fulton Smedley, R.F.D. #1, Zanesville, Ohio	WISCONSIN	(18) N. Wisconsin & Upper Michigan — Paul Wiersgalla, 222 Niagara St., Eau Claire, Wisconsin
	(17) *Northeast — Anthony L. Wysor, P.O. Box 592, Elyria, Ohio		(17) Southern — Robert White, 5300 W. Layton Avenue, Milwaukee, Wisc.
	(18) N. W. Ohio & S. E. Michigan — George Moore, 3557 Beechway Blvd., Toledo, Ohio	WYOMING	(18) Merrill Strong, Box 131, Evanston, Wyoming
	(18) South-Southwest Ohio & Northern Kentucky — Bob Frohmeyer, 1818 Lawn Avenue, Cincinnati, Ohio	PUERTO RICO	(18) Manuel Francisco Rodriguez, Calle 22, Bloque 47 #18, Urb. Santa Rosa, Bayamon
OKLAHOMA	(17) Woody Ward, 11201 North Brauer, Oklahoma City, Oklahoma	CANADA	
OREGON	(18) Ralph Lidman, 203 N.E. Steiger, Grants Pass, Oregon	PROVINCE	PANEL
PENNSYLVANIA	(17) Eastern — Louis Rhodes, 118 So. 50th Street, Philadelphia, Pa.	ALBERTA	(18) Ken Kyle, 5709 110th Street, Edmonton, Alberta, Canada
	(17) Western — Rose Behrhorst, 643 Locust Street, Johnstown, Pa.	BRITISH COLUMBIA/ YUKON	(17) Al Huble, 1470 Elm Street, Prince George, B.C., Canada
		MANITOBA	(18) Tom Grafton, 213 Notre Dame Avenue, Winnipeg, Manitoba, Can.

DELEGATES (cont'd)

ROSTER

PROVINCE

PANEL

- NEW BRUNSWICK & PRINCE EDWARD ISL. (18) Bill Gallant, Miscouche, Prince Edward Island, Canada
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